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PROJECT

«To Christians of the Third Millennium»

Part II

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Translated into English with the help of ChatGPT (GPT-5, OpenAI).

· XTT II — DOI (all versions): [10.5281/zenodo.21785619](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21785619)

Prologue

To Christians of the Third Millennium II (CTM II) was conceived as a continuation of the To Christians of the Third Millennium (CTM) project and develops one of the principal lines of inquiry introduced in the first volume. Accordingly, CTM II fully inherits both the conceptual vocabulary and the fundamental problematic established in CTM.

CTM II brings together four studies devoted to the architecture of human subjecthood.

Three of these constitute a single conceptual sequence. The Genesis of Subjecthood examines the conditions under which subjecthood becomes possible. The Ontogenesis of Subjecthood describes its formation within the concrete human person. Eschatological Subjecthood reveals the ultimate orientation of this becoming and its openness to the Foundation.

The Quality of Ontology occupies a different place. It is not another stage in the development of subjecthood but the foundational model of the entire CTM project. It describes the architecture of the relationship between the human person, society, and reality within which subjecthood arises, is formed, and is realized. For this reason, the architecture of subjecthood cannot be understood apart from the concept of the quality of ontology.

Yet a complete account requires more than describing the conditions, process, and direction of the emergence of subjecthood. It must also disclose its internal structure. This task is fulfilled by the third study, devoted to the ontogenesis of subjecthood, which connects the quality of ontology with the subject's capacity to generate history.

The order of the studies therefore follows a necessary logic:

Genesis → Quality of Ontology → Ontogenesis of Subjecthood → Eschatology

The first study examines the conditions for the emergence of subjecthood. The second introduces the foundational model without which its structure cannot be described. The third unfolds the ontogenesis of subjecthood. The fourth investigates its ultimate orientation.

CTM II should therefore be read not as a collection of independent essays but as the progressive unfolding of a single theme: the emergence, structure, and ultimate fulfillment of human subjecthood.

The Genesis of Subjecthood

As has already been established within the CTM project, subjecthood is understood not as an originally given autonomy, a social role, or a constellation of psychological functions, but as a mode of existence that arises through the human response to a reality that precedes it. The architecture of this emergence comprises three levels: the ontological presupposition—the presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality; the anthropological presuppositions—a taste for freedom, the capacity for expansion, and the acceptance of one's own expansiveness; and the pre-reflective axiomatics of the position of subjecthood—the hermeneutics of beginning, the hermeneutics of responsibility, methodological monotheism, and ontological verifiability. Their synthesis explains how the human being ceases to be merely one who has been begun and becomes one who himself begins. The result is not yet mature subjecthood, but its minimal configuration—the very birth of subjecthood—from which communication, projectuality, and historical agency may subsequently develop.

Since the second part of the CTM project is a direct continuation of the first, the terminology introduced and developed in the first volume is not redefined here.

1. The Problem of the Birth of the Subject

Modern thought has become accustomed to beginning either with an already constituted autonomous subject or with its deconstruction. In the former case, the subject is assumed to be a ready-made source of decision, meaning, and action; in the latter, it is revealed to be derivative of language, the body, power, history, the unconscious, and social structures. Despite the opposition between these approaches, they share a common presupposition: subjecthood is treated as something that either already exists or has already been exposed as an illusion. The very moment of its emergence—the transition from derivative existence to the subjecthood position—remains outside the field of inquiry.

CTM begins precisely with this neglected moment. It asks not whether the human being possesses some originally given subjecthood, but under what conditions and through what acts subjecthood comes into being at all. Accordingly, within the present study, the genesis of subjecthood must be understood neither as the unfolding of a pre-existing autonomy nor as the accumulation of psychological functions, social competencies, or capacities for action. Rather, it concerns the emergence of a distinctive mode of existence in which the human person accepts the reality that precedes him, discovers his own existence as demanding a response, and begins to shape that response in relation to the Foundation, allowing it to be tested by reality itself.

The central question of this study may therefore be formulated as follows:

How does the human being, who is originally one who has been begun, himself become one who begins?

Answering this question requires distinguishing three levels: the ontological presupposition of the birth of the subject, the anthropological presuppositions for the transition to subjecthood existence, and the pre-reflective axiomatics of the emerging subjecthood position. Their synthesis constitutes not mature subjecthood but its minimal configuration—the very birth of subjecthood, the threshold beyond which the human being first becomes capable not merely of continuing the

operation of causes that precede him, but of offering his own response to the gift of existence.

2. The Priority of Reality

The human being begins his existence within a reality already given to him. He does not choose the fact of his own birth, his body, his parents, his first language, his people, his historical epoch, his place, his cultural memory, or the greater part of his original circumstances. Even freedom discovers itself not in a vacuum but within that which precedes it.

This priority is not an accidental obstacle to subjecthood. On the contrary, without it the subject would have neither the material for a response, nor an addressee, nor a point of departure. An absolutely self-originating subject would not be a human being but a logical fiction: in order to begin himself, he would have to exist prior to his own beginning. The real human subject always begins as one who has already been begun.

Christian ontology gives this insight its fullest concreteness. "The Logos became flesh" means that human onticity has been affirmed as the space of encounter with God. The human person comes to the Logos not despite his bodily, historical, and cultural concreteness, but through it. God begins the human person concretely; therefore, the onticity from which he originates is not merely a collection of causes but also the first content of his possible response.

This does not imply the sacralization of every given form. One's origin may be wounded by violence, falsehood, sin, and historical injustice. To accept one's beginning does not mean declaring good everything that brought one's existence about or accompanied it. Rather, it signifies a more fundamental act: to acknowledge the reality of one's own beginning as irrevocably belonging to the truth of one's existence and as the material of responsibility that cannot be made never to have been.

3. The Ontological Presupposition: The Presumption of the Meaningful Determinacy of Reality

Prior to every subjecthood act there must exist a presupposition that belongs not to the human person but to reality itself. If reality were absolutely chaotic, mute, and indifferent to the manner of human existence, no response would be possible: no position could prove to be more or less adequate to reality than any other. This ontological presupposition is the meaningful determinacy of reality. Within the architecture of the emerging subjecthood position, it is accepted as the presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality.

The meaningful determinacy of reality is that property of reality by virtue of which different modes of human existence may stand in relations of correspondence or non-correspondence to it—relations that can be disclosed through experience. Accordingly, the presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality is the initial assumption that such a distinction exists and is, in principle, discoverable.

The meaningful determinacy of reality does not imply that reality is completely rational, exhaustively transparent to human reason, or reducible to a logical system. It affirms only the necessary minimum: reality is sufficiently determinate, coherent, and accessible for the human position to withstand it, to come into conflict with it, to be corrected by it, or to collapse upon collision with it.

Only on this basis do truth and error become possible. Error is not merely an opinion differing from another opinion but an unrecognized non-correspondence to reality. Truth is not simply the correctness of a proposition but the possibility of a mode of existence that corresponds more adequately to reality. The same principle also makes possible scientific discovery, repentance, and spiritual discernment: in each case the human person allows reality to reveal the inadequacy of a previous configuration.

At the ontological level, the meaningful determinacy of reality logically precedes the subject without reducing reality to the role of a mechanical judge. Reality's response may be delayed, ambiguous, and difficult to interpret. Experience requires hermeneutics, and verification requires discernment. Nevertheless, without the fundamental possibility of discovering correspondence and non-correspondence, every hermeneutic would become nothing more than a self-enclosed game of consciousness.

Within the theological horizon, the meaningful determinacy—or, more precisely, the intelligibility—of reality receives a stronger foundation: the world has been created through the Logos, and the human person is capable of participating in the logos-structure of creation. Yet an investigation into the genesis of subjecthood need not begin by asserting the complete rationality of the world. At this stage it is sufficient to recognize that reality is not indifferent to the truthfulness of the human mode of existence.

The essential distinction may therefore be expressed as follows:

The meaningful determinacy of reality is a property of reality; the presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality is the human person's pre-reflective acceptance of that property.

4. Anthropological Presuppositions

The intelligibility of reality alone is not sufficient. Reality may make a response possible, yet the human person remains capable of evading that response, preferring ready-made derivative existence, or retreating into what is already given. The second level of the architecture therefore consists of the anthropological presuppositions of the birth of the subject.

The first of these is a taste for freedom. This is not freedom as an already attained state, nor the abstract ability to choose between alternatives. Rather, a taste for freedom is the existential disposition to prefer one's own response over the mere reproduction of external or internal determination. The human person has not yet become a subject, but is no longer satisfied with remaining merely the product of causes.

A taste for freedom cannot be produced by logical demonstration. One may demonstrate the advantages of subjecthood existence, but the preference for freedom itself is made at a level deeper than reflective calculation. For this reason, it is not an axiom of the subjecthood position but an anthropological condition that makes the emergence of that position possible.

The second presupposition is the capacity for expansion. Living human existence is not enclosed within its present configuration. It is capable of expanding the sphere of understanding, responsibility, presence, action, and creativity; of appropriating

what is still unknown; of entering into new relationships; and of bringing into being what has never existed before.

Expansiveness must not be confused with domination, conquest, or the suppression of the Other. It is a more fundamental capacity of being to move beyond what has already been actualized. It may assume destructive forms, yet in itself it is the indispensable condition of every form of growth, learning, repentance, and creativity.

The capacity for expansion does not yet imply its acceptance. A person may fear his own agency, diminish the sphere of responsibility, hide within prescribed roles, or regard every movement beyond the given as illegitimate. The transition to the subjecthood position therefore begins with a distinct act: the acceptance of one's own expansiveness—the acknowledgment that my existence both can and is called to transcend its present givenness.

The distinction may be stated precisely:

A taste for freedom is an existential disposition.

Expansiveness is an anthropological capacity.

The acceptance of one's own expansiveness is the first threshold act on the path toward subjecthood.

Taken together, these explain why the human person is capable not only of responding to reality but also of deciding to make that response his own.

5. The Pre-Reflective Axiomatics of the Subjecthood Position

The presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality explains the possibility of a response, while the anthropological presuppositions explain the movement toward such a response. Yet subjecthood comes into being only when that response acquires a definite internal structure. This structure is constituted by four pre-reflective principles: the hermeneutics of beginning, the hermeneutics of responsibility, methodological monotheism, and ontological verifiability.

These principles are called pre-reflective not because they can never become objects of conscious reflection. On the contrary, philosophical analysis makes them explicit. Initially, however, they function as ultimate practical dispositions that precede any articulated theory of the self. The human person already lives from them before he is able to formulate them conceptually.

These four principles are not a collection of independent virtues. They form a necessary sequence: to acknowledge what has been received; to accept the necessity of one's own response; to determine its ultimate orientation; and to allow its truthfulness to be tested. The absence of any one of these elements distorts the birth of the subject.

5.1. The Hermeneutics of Beginning

The human person does not choose his origin. He chooses the hermeneutics of his origin.

The same originating onticity may be interpreted as accident, error, curse, injustice, privilege, resource, destiny, or gift. The object of primordial freedom is therefore not the past as a collection of unchangeable facts, but the manner in which the human person incorporates that past into his own existence.

The hermeneutics of beginning starts with the acceptance of the reality that precedes us and of the fact that we ourselves have been begun. This means

acknowledging one's own finitude: I am not the absolute beginning or the source of myself. My existence was received before it could ever become the object of my own decision. Consequently, the onticity from which I originate must be taken seriously—as a reality I did not choose, yet within which I came into being and apart from which I cannot understand my own beginning.

To accept one's beginning does not mean affirming everything that produced it as good; it means taking its reality seriously and acknowledging one's own derivation from it.

Acceptance is not equivalent to passive acquiescence in everything that exists, nor does it require gratitude for evil. Rather, it signifies the refusal to construct subjecthood upon the denial of the fact of one's own origin. Even that which must later be healed, overcome, or judged must first be acknowledged as part of the real history of my beginning.

For this reason, the hermeneutics of beginning precedes the hermeneutics of responsibility. One cannot assume responsibility for the continuation of something whose existence one has not yet acknowledged. Before the originating onticity can become a vocation, it must first be accepted as reality.

5.2. The Hermeneutics of Responsibility

The acknowledged beginning may remain nothing more than an object of explanation. A human person does not choose his body, parents, language, people, historical epoch, or history itself: all these precede his freedom. Yet while he does not choose his origin, he does choose the hermeneutics of his origin. The same beginning may be understood as accident, error, curse, injustice, privilege, resource, destiny, or gift.

The transition to subjecthood occurs when the human person understands the existence he has received as calling for his own response. Here the hermeneutics of responsibility comes into being. It transforms origin from mere causality into vocation, and the onticity that gave rise to the human person from a collection of circumstances into the space of a free response.

Responsibility here is broader than guilt and cannot be derived solely from authorship of past actions. A person is not guilty of what he did not choose, yet he is capable of assuming responsibility for how what has been received will be continued, healed, or transformed in and through him. The first subjecthood act is therefore not autonomy but the acceptance of responsibility.

The primary act of the subject is a response to a gift.

The gift in question is not every concrete form that one's past has taken, but the very existence one has received together with the possibility of responding. Accordingly, acknowledging the gift neither abolishes judgment upon evil nor requires the perpetuation of every inherited form. On the contrary, it transforms even a wounded beginning into the place of responsible action and refuses to allow evil to pronounce the final word concerning the meaning of existence.

The choice of the hermeneutics of responsibility is simultaneously a choice in favor of the image of the Creator. The human person consents not merely to exist within an already given world, but to participate in its further becoming. Responsibility thus becomes the first ontological act of creativity. It is here that the

possibility of tikkun olam opens—the human participation in the restoration, healing, and continuation of the world.

Resistance to responsibility often assumes the form of resistance to one's own finitude. To embrace the hermeneutics of responsibility is to acknowledge that I am not the absolute beginning or the source of myself: my existence has been initiated by another, and only a limited portion of reality has been entrusted to me. The human person prefers to regard himself either as a pure victim of causes or as an absolutely self-originating being. The first position deprives him of the possibility of beginning; the second denies everything by which he has already been begun. The hermeneutics of responsibility holds both truths together: I did not create my own beginning, yet it depends upon me how that beginning will be continued.

It is precisely here that the human person ceases to be merely a result. By acknowledging reality and accepting responsibility for responding to it, he passes from the position of one who has been begun to that of one who himself begins. Yet responsibility alone is still insufficient. A response may be energetic and autonomous while remaining oriented toward a derivative foundation. A further principle is therefore required: the principle of ultimate orientation.

5.3. Methodological Monotheism

The human person exists among a multitude of foundations: bodily needs, family, people, state, culture, profession, ideology, success, security, and recognition. Each of these is real and capable of organizing human action. Yet if they are all granted equal ultimate status, the subject becomes divided among competing centers and loses the ability to establish a hierarchy of responsibility.

Methodological monotheism is the requirement to identify a single supreme Foundation in relation to which all derivative foundations receive their proper place and measure. It is called methodological because, at the level of the theory of the genesis of subjecthood, it describes above all the structure of orientation rather than replacing the fullness of theological confession.

For the Christian, the supreme Foundation is the Triune God revealed in the Logos. Yet the broader meaning of the principle can be formulated even before its confessional articulation: a response becomes genuinely an act of subjecthood only when it acquires an ultimate orientation instead of dissolving into the accidental competition of partial goals.

Methodological monotheism does not abolish the plurality of human attachments. It does not require the rejection of the body, the family, the people, or history. On the contrary, it enables them to be accepted without being absolutized. A derivative foundation retains its true dignity precisely when it is not compelled to assume the role of the Absolute. Methodological monotheism thus affirms the primacy of one reality over the multiplicity of derivative foundations.

In this way, the hermeneutics of responsibility receives its criterion of direction. The human person accepts not merely the obligation to continue what has been received, but the obligation to relate that continuation to the supreme Foundation. Within this framework, faith is understood not as the acceptance of a set of doctrines but as the capacity to maintain orientation toward the supreme Foundation amid a multiplicity of derivative foundations.

5.4. Ontological Verifiability

Even a response that possesses a clear ultimate orientation may nevertheless prove to be mistaken. The human person is capable of mistaking his own interpretation of the Foundation for the Foundation itself, of sanctifying prejudice, error, or self-interest, thereby rendering subjecthood hermetically closed. The final act constituting the minimal subjecthood position is therefore ontological verifiability.

Ontological verifiability is the willingness to allow reality to test and correct not only individual judgments but one's very mode of existence. It is the subjecthood counterpart to the presumption of the meaningful determinacy of reality: reality is capable of disclosing correspondence or non-correspondence, and the subject consents to be revealed as either corresponding or failing to correspond to it.

Here lies the boundary between subjecthood and sovereign arbitrariness. The subject not only makes decisions but remains open to correction by that which is not his own construction. His freedom consists not in immunity from reality but in the capacity to transform himself in response to its truth.

Ontological verification must not be reduced to immediate practical success. Falsehood may triumph for a time, while truth may lead to suffering. Verification requires the perspective of time, the discernment of different levels of reality, and openness to Revelation. Within the theory of the genesis of subjecthood, however, the task is not to describe every mode of verification but to establish the subject's fundamental willingness not to regard himself as the final authority concerning the truth about himself.

Without verifiability, methodological monotheism degenerates into the dogmatization of one's own image of the Foundation; responsibility into self-will; the acceptance of one's beginning into the mythologization of one's origin; and expansiveness into domination. Verifiability preserves the subjecthood position as open to reality and thereby completes its minimal structure.

6. The Logic of the Birth of the Subject

The three levels of this architecture possess different ontological statuses. The meaningful determinacy of reality is a property of reality itself. A taste for freedom and the capacity for expansion belong to human nature. The four axiomatic principles constitute the structure of the emerging subjecthood position. These levels cannot be reduced to a single category. Yet only together do they explain the event of the birth of the subject.

Their logic may be expressed in a threefold formula:

Reality makes a response possible.

The human person chooses to respond.

The axiomatics of the subjecthood position gives that response its form.

Very schematically, this sequence may be represented as follows:

Presumption of the Meaningful Determinacy of Reality → Taste for Freedom → Capacity for Expansion → Acceptance of One's Own Expansiveness → Hermeneutics of Beginning → Hermeneutics of Responsibility → Methodological Monotheism → Ontological Verifiability → Minimal Subjecthood Position

This sequence is logical, not necessarily chronological. In lived experience, its elements may arise simultaneously, recur, weaken, and be embraced anew. A person may practice responsibility before clearly articulating his relation to his

beginning, or seek the supreme Foundation before consciously accepting his own expansiveness. The theory reconstructs the conditions of the integrity of the subjecthood position; it does not impose a universal psychological chronology.

The birth of the subject is therefore both an event and a task. The minimal subjecthood position may indeed be assumed once, yet each of its elements continually requires renewed confirmation. Subjecthood does not become an inalienable possession: the human person remains capable of abandoning his response, subordinating it to a derivative foundation, or closing himself to verification. Nevertheless, every genuine restoration begins with the same architecture.

7. The Minimal Subjecthood Position

The result of the foregoing genesis is not yet a mature subject—historically effective and communicatively realized. What emerges is only the minimal subjecthood position: sufficient for the human person to cease being merely derivative and to begin assuming responsibility for the direction of his own existence.

Expressed in the first person, it may be formulated as follows:

I accept the reality that precedes me and my own beginning. I recognize the existence I have received as a gift calling for my response. I accept my capacity to move beyond my present givenness. I orient my response toward the supreme Foundation, while allowing reality itself to test and correct me.

There is no assertion of absolute autonomy in this position. The subject is born not in spite of dependence, but through its responsible interpretation. He does not deny his derivativeness; rather, he refuses to remain merely derivative. His freedom does not create a beginning *ex nihilo* but transforms the beginning he has received into his own response.

The first principle of the genesis of subjecthood may therefore be formulated as follows:

A human being cannot become a subject without accepting the reality of his own beginning; yet he becomes a subject only when he transforms that accepted beginning into his own response—a response that is ultimately oriented and open to verification.

At this moment the human person ceases to be merely one who has been begun and himself becomes one who begins. He has not yet conceived a project, entered mature communication, or transformed society. Yet the one capable of doing so has now come into being—the one who has, for the first time, assumed the subjecthood position with respect to his own existence.

Conclusion

The theory of the genesis of subjecthood makes it possible to avoid two opposite reductions. The first explains the subject in terms of self-contained autonomy and overlooks the fact that every human freedom is already situated within a reality that precedes it. The second dissolves the human person into the structures that gave rise to him and fails to explain how an authentic response can emerge from within derivativeness itself.

Subjecthood is born at the boundary between what has been received and what is begun. Reality must possess meaningful determinacy; the human person must

possess a taste for freedom and the capacity to transcend what is merely given; and his response must take the form of the hermeneutics of beginning, the hermeneutics of responsibility, methodological monotheism, and ontological verifiability.

The genesis of subjecthood is therefore neither liberation from every form of dependence nor the negation of finitude. It is the transformation of dependence into responsibility; the acceptance of finitude as the place of response; not self-grounding, but the beginning of one's own action within an existence that has already been given.

With this, the investigation into the birth of the subject reaches its conclusion. Everything that follows—the development of communication, the quality of ontology, projectuality, and historical agency—presupposes an already born subject and belongs to the subsequent stages of his ontological biography.

The Quality of Ontology

The Architecture, Functionality, and Subjecthood of Dynamic Iconic Space

Whereas the previous phase of the CTM project was primarily concerned with subjecthood, communication, and faith, its further development led to a new question: the structure and quality of the ontology within which subjecthood is formed and actualized in human existence. Framing the problem in this way required an investigation into the structure and dynamics of ontology itself, since ontology constitutes the inner environment within which subjecthood is formed, acquires its specific quality, and becomes actualized in perception, evaluation, project formation, and action.

The need to move beyond the content of ontology toward an analysis of its structure, dynamics, and functional adequacy led to the further development and systematization of the concept of the quality of ontology, first introduced in CTM I. This concept denotes the capacity of an ontology to sustain the complexity of reality, preserve orientation toward the Foundation, provide a complete cycle of interaction with the world, form subjecthood, and become actualized in both personal biography and history. Such an approach makes it possible to understand ontology not merely as a collection of propositions about being, but as a process that can be analyzed, modeled, and intentionally transformed.

The human capacity to become a subject, the quality of culture and collective subjecthood, the possibility of social development, the resilience of civilizations in times of crisis, and their capacity for historical creativity depend not only on the content of the ideas they profess. They also depend on the structure of the ontology within which those ideas are perceived, interconnected, evaluated, verified, and translated into action.

The principal difficulty lies in the fact that the quality of ontology cannot be expressed by a single indicator. An ontology may be highly complex yet lifeless; energetic yet primitive; profound yet historically sterile; effective yet oriented toward a derivative foundation. Its evaluation therefore requires a multidimensional model.

The present study proposes a three-dimensional model of the quality of ontology, distinguishing three interrelated dimensions:

Ontology as Dynamic Iconic Space (DIS) — the reality that the subject is capable of holding, and the manner in which he holds it;

Ontology as an Operating System (OS) — the operations that the subject is capable of performing in interaction with reality.

Ontology as Subjecthood — whether a person or a collective is capable of being an autonomous and authentic source of evaluation, decision, responsibility, projectuality, and history.

Ontology as an operating system is articulated through three functional circuits:
the receptive–interpretive circuit;
the projective–executive circuit;
the reflective–corrective circuit.

The model is permeated by three transversal elements:

ontological competence as a meta-competence;
ontological falsifiability as the condition of a genuine relation to truth;
ontological asceticism as the subject's capacity to receive the transforming influence of reality, the Other, and the Foundation.

These three dimensions correspond to three axes of the ontological profile. They do not form a hierarchy: none is intrinsically higher or lower than the others. The model makes it possible to correlate architectural maturity, functional adequacy, axiological orientation, personal productivity, and historical productivity without reducing them to a single linear scale.

In the process of actualization, however, a directed dependency emerges among the three dimensions:

Dynamic Iconic Space → Operating System → Subjecthood → History

1. Ontology as Dynamic Iconic Space

Within CTM, ontology is understood neither as a branch of philosophy nor as a completed worldview.

In technical terms:

Ontology is the internalized Dynamic Iconic Space (DIS) of images, meanings, narratives, relations, and models through which the subject perceives, interprets, evaluates, organizes, and lives reality.

This space cannot be imagined as a single "inner movie." Rather, it is a multidimensional environment in which images and scenes, symbols and maps, memory and narratives, models of the past and present, scenarios of the future, value configurations, representations of oneself and others, and images of the Foundation coexist simultaneously.

Its principal elements are:

images — the primary iconic units;

scenes — spatial-event configurations;

narratives — connections among scenes across time;

symbols — concentrated nodes of meaning;

maps — models of locations and relationships;

scenarios — models of possible developments;

value configurations — modes of distinguishing what is significant;

images of the subject — representations of oneself and of the other;

images of time — ways of interpreting the past, organizing the present, and opening possible futures;

images of the Foundation — the ultimate orienting references of ontology.

Dynamic Iconic Space is continuously reconfigured under the influence of experience, culture, communication, thought, faith, and action. Ontology is therefore not a repository of knowledge but the living environment of human existence.

2. The Quality of Ontology: Concept and Three-Dimensional Model

The quality of ontology is neither the truthfulness of individual beliefs nor the quantity of accumulated information. A person may possess a vast amount of true information while remaining incapable of integrating it, discerning its significance, relating it to the Foundation, or transforming it into responsible action.

The quality of ontology is the degree to which Dynamic Iconic Space is capable of adequately holding reality, maintaining orientation toward the Foundation, carrying out the full cycle of interaction with the world, forming subjecthood, and enabling the development of both persons and societies.

A high-quality ontology does more than explain the world. It enables one to live within it, understand it, learn from it, be transformed through encounter with it, and responsibly participate in its transformation.

This definition unfolds through three interconnected dimensions:

architectural quality — the structure of Dynamic Iconic Space itself;

functional quality — the functioning of ontology as an operating system;

subjecthood quality — the capacity to evaluate, project, and act independently.

Groundedness and axiological orientation do not constitute a fourth dimension. Rather, they permeate all three dimensions and determine the orientation toward which their capacities are directed.

These three dimensions cannot be reduced to a single scale. Each must be evaluated independently, while the overall quality of ontology is determined by their configuration and their orientation toward the Foundation.

3. The First Dimension: The Architectural Quality of Dynamic Iconic Space

Architectural quality answers the question:

What kind of reality, and in what form, is the subject capable of holding?

It is described by the following parameters.

3.1. Scope, Horizon, and Scale of Claim

Spatial scope indicates how much of reality Dynamic Iconic Space encompasses: one's own body, the family, the community, the people, the state, humanity, or creation as a whole.

Temporal scope indicates the horizon it is capable of holding: the present moment, the near future, a human lifetime, a generation, the history of a people, civilizations, or the eschatological horizon.

Scale of claim determines the extent of reality to which the subject extends meaning, action, and responsibility.

This does not necessarily coincide with the scope of one's map. One may perceive a vast world while considering oneself responsible for nothing beyond personal comfort. Conversely, an excessive scale of claim combined with limited scope and low ontological resolution may become profoundly destructive.

3.2. Dimensionality, Multi-Level Structure, and Multi-Process Capacity

Dimensionality refers to the number of independent dimensions that ontology can hold simultaneously: personal, social, historical, political, economic, moral, religious, and metaphysical. The greater the dimensionality, the less flat the ontology becomes. Multi-level structure is the capacity to distinguish among events, actions, conscious and unconscious motives, relationships, structures, foundations, and the Foundation itself. It prevents confusing surface manifestations with deeper causes and guards against mistaking derivative foundations for the ultimate Foundation. Multi-process capacity is the ability to sustain multiple simultaneously unfolding

processes: personal, familial, political, cultural, spiritual, and historical. Reality is not a single linear narrative, and mature Dynamic Iconic Space does not reduce it to one.

3.3. Resolution and Coherence (Structural Integration)

Resolution expresses the precision with which elements of reality are represented: the ability to distinguish nuances, motives, degrees of responsibility, contexts, exceptions, and subtle changes. Structural complexity indicates the richness and development of the connections among the elements of Dynamic Iconic Space. It is the capacity to perceive not only objects and events but also the relationships between them. Coherence describes the interconnectedness of the various regions of the internal space. A fragmented Dynamic Iconic Space may contain abundant knowledge that never interacts; a coherent one forms an integrated—though not necessarily closed—configuration. Hierarchical organization enables one to distinguish what is primary from what is secondary, foundations from derivative foundations, ends from means, norm from deviation, value from function. Without hierarchy, the space collapses into a chaotic collection of equally weighted elements. Chromatic richness denotes the capacity to perceive nuance, complexity, and ambiguity. A monochromatic Dynamic Iconic Space is governed by rigid binary oppositions. A richly chromatic one preserves subtle gradations without abandoning the distinction between truth and falsehood or between good and evil.

3.4. Depth, Structural Elaboration, Dynamism, and Openness

Depth indicates how far ontology is capable of penetrating from visible events toward their foundations.

Its trajectory unfolds as:

event → motive → structure → foundation → Foundation

Structural elaboration refers to the completeness of the internal architecture.

Some ontologies consist of little more than a handful of unformed intuitions; others possess clearly articulated distinctions, categories, internal logic, interconnected structures, and multi-layered organization. Dynamism is the plasticity of Dynamic Iconic Space itself: its ability to reconfigure, integrate new elements, reorganize relationships, generate new scenarios, alter scale, and reshape images of both the past and the future. This is not yet the activity of the operating system but rather the intrinsic capacity of the iconic space to be restructured. Openness expresses the willingness to leave room for reality that has not yet been represented within ontology. A high-quality Dynamic Iconic Space recognizes a fundamental truth: It is always smaller than the reality it seeks to hold. This awareness prevents ontology from identifying its own map with the world itself and preserves the possibility of further knowledge.

3.5. Interiorization and the Capacity to Hold Contradiction

One of the fundamental characteristics of Dynamic Iconic Space (DIS) is its capacity to perceive, interiorize, and hold contradiction without prematurely eliminating one of its poles or reducing the complexity of reality to an artificially contradiction-free scheme. Contradiction becomes part of the subject's internal space and is preserved within it as a tension requiring further discernment and continued work. The broader Dynamic Iconic Space becomes, the more complex, multi-layered, and ontologically charged contradictions the subject is able to contain

without resorting to repression, false reconciliation, or the mechanical adoption of one pole at the expense of the other. This is not the cultivation of logical inconsistency. Rather, it is the capacity not to destroy the genuine complexity of reality before it has been understood. The capacity to hold contradiction belongs to the architectural dimension of the quality of ontology. The operating system, by contrast, is responsible for the dialectical work performed upon the contradiction that has already been perceived and interiorized: analyzing its structure, distinguishing its levels, seeking mediations, and transforming contradiction into a source of new understanding. This distinction may be summarized as follows: Dynamic Iconic Space determines what contradictions the subject is capable of perceiving, interiorizing, and holding. The operating system determines what the subject is capable of doing with those contradictions. Subjecthood determines what decision the subject is capable of making and for what he is prepared to assume responsibility. The architectural parameters must not be combined mechanically. A broad scope without resolution produces crude generalizations. Resolution without scope results in the loss of the whole. Complexity without coherence leads to fragmentation. Hierarchy without openness degenerates into dogmatic closure. Openness without hierarchy makes meaningful discernment impossible. Quality therefore emerges from the coherence of these parameters, not from their isolated maximization.

4. The Second Dimension: Ontology as an Operating System

If Dynamic Iconic Space describes the subject's internal environment, the operating system describes the manner in which that environment interacts with reality. The metaphor of an operating system is employed here in a strictly analytical sense. It does not mechanize the human person; rather, it enables us to distinguish the functions through which perception becomes understanding, significance becomes choice, possibility becomes actuality, and experience becomes the source of learning.

These functions do not constitute one long linear sequence. Instead, they form three interconnected functional circuits:

- the receptive—interpretive circuit;
- the projective—executive circuit;
- the reflective—corrective circuit.

Each performs its own task, yet none operates in isolation.

The outcome of every action returns to the subject, reshapes perception and interpretation, tests values and projects, and, when necessary, reconfigures Dynamic Iconic Space itself.

4.1. The Receptive—Interpretive Circuit

The receptive—interpretive circuit answers three fundamental questions:

What does the subject notice?

How does the subject understand it?

What significance does the subject assign to it?

Perception determines which portion of reality becomes accessible to ontology in the first place: objects and subjects, relationships and processes, foundations and contradictions, threats and opportunities, changes and ruptures. A defect in

perception renders part of reality invisible even before reflection begins. What has not been perceived can neither be understood nor incorporated into responsible action.

Interpretation transforms perception into meaning. It classifies phenomena, identifies relationships, distinguishes levels, searches for causes, and constructs a model of the situation. Even accurate perception may be nullified by faulty interpretation whenever new events are forcibly incorporated into an already established scheme.

Axiology determines what within perceived reality possesses significance. It distinguishes good from evil, the primary from the secondary, ends from means, and the permissible from the impermissible. Memory places present experience within a broader temporal context.

It may be:

- working memory;
- long-term memory;
- archival memory;
- procedural memory;
- generative memory.

In the last case, the past is not merely preserved but becomes material for the creative construction of both the present and the future.

The trigger system connects perception with the activation of internal processes. Its quality depends not only upon sensitivity and speed of response but also upon the ability to distinguish genuine challenges from false activations and to recalibrate its own thresholds through experience.

4.2. The Projective–Executive Circuit

The projective–executive circuit answers the question:

What is the subject capable of doing with the reality that has been understood and evaluated?

Competencies determine the range of operations available to the subject:

- discernment;
- forecasting;
- integration;
- coordination;
- project formation;
- mobilization;
- learning;
- restoration.

Competencies do not determine ends in themselves. Rather, they establish the boundaries of what is practically possible. A subject cannot realize a project for which he lacks the necessary language, skills, organizational forms, or capacity for collaborative action.

This circuit also encompasses the dialectical work upon contradiction that has already been perceived and retained within Dynamic Iconic Space. The operating system analyzes its structure, distinguishes ontic from ontological levels, identifies false oppositions, searches for mediations, and transforms tension into a source of new understanding. Dynamic Iconic Space determines the capacity to contain

contradiction. The operating system determines the productivity of working with contradiction.

Navigation selects a direction by relating goals, means, circumstances, and the Foundation. It includes:

- goal formation;
- strategic planning;
- course maintenance;
- the capacity for reorientation.

Navigational effectiveness must not be confused with speed. Rapid movement in the wrong direction merely increases the scale of error.

Decision transforms a multiplicity of possibilities into a definite choice. Execution introduces that choice into onticity through mobilization, coordination, resource allocation, and control. It is here that the operating system comes into contact with subjecthood. Functions may prepare alternatives and enable action, but only the subject is capable of making the decision itself and assuming responsibility for it.

4.3. The Reflective–Corrective Circuit

The reflective–corrective circuit answers the question: Is the subject capable of allowing reality to transform his own understanding, action, and even himself?

Verification compares perception, interpretation, expectation, and outcome with reality. Its central question is not merely whether the intended goal has been achieved, but also whether the goal itself was rightly conceived, whether reality has been distorted by the model through which it was perceived, and whether apparent success has been purchased at the cost of destroying the subject, the Other, or the relationship to the Foundation.

Self-correction revises interpretations, strategies, competencies, and projects and, when necessary, restructures the very connections and configuration of Dynamic Iconic Space itself. Without self-correction, error gradually becomes incorporated into identity and begins defending itself against every attempt at refutation.

Self-development is more than the accumulation of new tools. It expands perception, deepens memory, increases resolution, restructures inadequate models, and forms new modes of action. Consequently, a completed cycle does not merely return ontology to its previous state but makes possible the next cycle on a higher level of quality.

Thus, the operating system possesses a cyclical architecture:

perception and interpretation → projection and execution → verification and correction → transformed perception

The completeness of its functional quality is determined not by the number of individual operations but by the coherence of these three circuits. Receptivity without projectuality leaves the subject a mere observer. Projectuality without verification turns the subject into a prisoner of his own will. Correction without stable orientation deprives him of direction. A mature operating system is capable of seeing, acting, and learning while maintaining mobilization toward the Foundation.

5. The Third Dimension: Ontology as Subjecthood

The dimension of subjecthood addresses the question: Is a person or a collective capable of being an autonomous and authentic source of evaluation, decision,

responsibility, projectuality, and history? Ontological seriousness is the readiness to receive reality, one's own life, oneself, and responsibility as genuinely significant. Without it, all other characteristics are reduced to nothing more than a game of models. Ontological freedom is the capacity to orient one's ontology independently in relation to reality and the Foundation. This is not the arbitrary construction of the world but the freedom to revise one's own iconic space in response to reality. Yet subjecthood cannot be derived entirely from knowledge, education, or even from the sophistication of the operating system. To recognize derivativeness as an unacceptable condition, the person must already possess a primordial disposition toward freedom. Within CTM this disposition is called the taste for freedom. The taste for freedom is an innate, pre-reflective sensitivity to the inauthenticity of derivative existence and an inner resistance to becoming merely a derivative function of another's will, another's ontology, or another's project. It may be cultivated, educated, disciplined, or suppressed, but it cannot be fully produced by education alone. Before freedom becomes a consciously articulated value, it must first be experienced as an inner preference for authentic existence over derivative existence. The taste for freedom does not itself reveal what is true or which foundation is genuine. It may generate not only freedom but also arbitrariness, egocentrism, or the nihilistic rejection of every form of belonging. Thus, the taste for freedom awakens subjecthood, but only orientation toward the Foundation gives freedom its direction, transforming it from arbitrariness into authenticity. It is therefore necessary to distinguish:

- the taste for freedom as an innate disposition;
- the consciousness of freedom as its reflective understanding;
- the competence of freedom as the capacity to distinguish the authentic from the derivative;
- the practice of freedom as the ability to choose and assume responsibility for one's choices;
- subjecthood as the stable realization of freedom in evaluation, decision, projectuality, and history.

The subjecthood of ontology is the capacity to form independently a system of values and criteria of evaluation, to interpret the past, evaluate the present, project the future, create the means of realizing it, and revise those projects in light of reality. Non-derivativeness expresses the degree of autonomy in ontological navigation. It does not imply the absence of inheritance. Every ontology receives language, memory, and forms from others. It becomes non-derivative only when it is capable of recognizing what has been inherited, critically verifying it, and responsibly appropriating or transforming it instead of living entirely by means of an external foundation. Projectuality is the capacity to create one's own future. Generativity extends this capacity further by producing new meanings, forms of activity, institutions, cultural forms, and modes of existence. The human quality of an ontology is evaluated primarily in terms of Logos-centeredness and solidarity. The strength and autonomy of ontology are not self-sufficient virtues if they are achieved by reducing another human being to an object or a resource. The scale of subjecthood is the integrated capacity to hold together space, time, complexity, responsibility, freedom, and action. Historical subjecthood manifests itself in the capacity to create and transform history, to learn from it, and to transmit

subjecthood to subsequent generations. Subjecthood therefore cannot be reduced to the mere possession of free will. A person becomes a subject to the extent that he is capable of receiving reality, developing, verifying, restructuring, and deepening his ontology in relation to reality and the Foundation, and then assuming responsibility for bringing that ontology into action.

Applied to ontology itself, subjecthood does not mean that ontology becomes a separate subject. Rather, it denotes the degree to which ontology enables its bearers to become the source of their own axiological, hermeneutical, and projectual logic. It is manifested in the ability to establish independently a hierarchy of values, interpret the past and the present from within one's own foundation, open the space of the possible, and shape an image of the future. Thus, the subjecthood of ontology characterizes not merely the presence of activity but the authorship of its meanings, evaluations, and projects.

6. The Transversal Criterion: Groundedness and Axiological Orientation

Functional effectiveness and autonomy alone do not determine the quality of ontology in its fullest sense. One must also ask:

Toward what are they directed?

Groundedness reveals the foundations upon which the subject stands and whether he is capable of distinguishing derivative foundations from the ultimate Foundation. Nation, state, security, progress, or social justice may all function as genuine foundations of historical action, yet they lose their proper place when they are treated as the ultimate horizon of being.

Methodological groundedness is the capacity of an ontology to understand its own origin, tradition, methods, limits, and place among other ontological projects. It renders its own presuppositions visible and therefore open to critique.

Transcendent openness is the principled readiness to receive both reality and the Foundation as exceeding every existing model. It is not a rejection of determinacy. Rather, it forbids the absolutization of what is derivative or already complete.

Responsibility requires the scale of one's claims to correspond to the scale of one's assumed responsibility. A subject cannot claim the authority to shape the world while refusing to bear the cost of the consequences of his own project.

Ontological solvency is the willingness to pay the price for truth, freedom, subjecthood, and fidelity to the Foundation. An ontology that remains operative only until the first serious loss may be intellectually persuasive while remaining existentially bankrupt.

Groundedness functions as a transversal criterion, because architectural complexity, functional effectiveness, and subjective autonomy may equally serve the ultimate Foundation or derivative—even false—foundations.

6.1. The Principle of Ontological Falsifiability

The quality of a foundation cannot be established merely by declaring fidelity to truth. Every false ontology is capable of proclaiming its own foundations to be ultimate and interpreting every objection as confirmation of its correctness. For this reason, groundedness must include the principle of ontological falsifiability.

Ontological falsifiability is the principled capacity of the existing configuration of an ontology to be called into question by reality, the Other, and the Foundation. It

means that no image, mode of interpretation, project, or derivative foundation may be protected in advance from examination merely because it has become part of the subject's identity or has been sanctified by tradition.

Falsifiability does not imply relativism, nor does it require abandoning truth. On the contrary, it follows from the distinction between truth itself and every human mode of holding that truth. The more seriously an ontology takes truth, the less entitled it is to identify its own present configuration with truth itself.

A high-quality ontology must be capable of being defeated by reality without losing its capacity to seek truth. An ontology that transforms every contradiction into confirmation of itself may be architecturally sophisticated, functionally effective, and historically powerful, yet its overall quality remains fundamentally defective.

6.2. Ontological Asceticism

If ontological falsifiability is a property of ontology, ontological asceticism is the practical capacity of the subject to accept such falsification.

Ontological asceticism is the disciplined readiness to relinquish images, interpretations, value configurations, projects, and derivative foundations whenever they are shown to be inconsistent with reality, the Other, or the ultimate Foundation.

It requires a distinctive form of freedom:

the capacity not to defend an error merely because a high price has already been paid for it;

not to transform the failure of a project into the denial of reality;

and not to preserve a false foundation merely for the sake of continuity in one's personal biography or collective memory.

Without ontological asceticism, verification remains only a formal procedure. The subject receives evidence of error but does not allow that evidence to reshape himself.

The fullness of the quality of ontology is therefore determined not only by the extent to which it can comprehend and transform reality, but also by whether it is capable of allowing reality, the Other, and the Foundation to transform itself.

7. Multidimensional Evaluation and the Ontological Profile

7.1. Structural Maturity, Vitality, and Subjecthood

It is particularly important to distinguish structural maturity, vitality, and subjecthood within ontology.

These belong to different dimensions, and none can serve as an indicator of the others.

Structural maturity answers the question:

How well organized is the ontology's internal architecture?

It includes coherence, architectural integrity, systematic organization, structural articulation, and the mutual integration of its elements.

The vitality of ontology is its capacity to actualize, reproduce, and develop itself; to generate forms of perception, evaluation, project formation, and action that are intrinsic to it; to preserve itself under external pressure; to resist competing ontologies; and, through its bearers, to establish its own axiological and projectual logic—first within interiorized reality and subsequently within social and historical reality.

The vitality of ontology answers the question:

To what extent is an ontology capable of sustaining life and action—responding, mobilizing, adapting rapidly, and preserving active energy?

A structurally sophisticated ontology may nevertheless prove lifeless and incapable of mobilizing the subject. Conversely, a primitive ontology may possess extraordinary energy and enormous mobilizing power. Historical effectiveness therefore does not, by itself, demonstrate the maturity of an ontology, just as theoretical depth does not guarantee its capacity to enter history.

Vitality and subjecthood must likewise be distinguished. Vitality asks whether an ontology possesses the power to live and act. Subjecthood asks whether the action carried out through its bearers is genuinely its own—that is, whether it proceeds from an independently appropriated foundation and from its own axiological, hermeneutical, and projectual logic. An ontology may be extraordinarily vital, vigorously reproducing itself and mobilizing its adherents, while remaining entirely derivative and serving someone else's project. Conversely, it may possess its own coherent system of values, interpretation of the past, and vision of the future, while lacking sufficient vitality for social reproduction and historical realization. Vitality determines an ontology's capacity to enter history. Subjecthood determines its capacity to enter history not as the vehicle of another's projectuality but as the source of its own.

7.2. False Identifications

The distinction between the three dimensions enables us to avoid several false identifications. First, complexity is not equivalent to truth. A rich and coherent ontology may rest upon a false foundation. Second, functional effectiveness is not equivalent to humaneness—that is, to the human quality of an ontology. A system may excel in perception, prediction, mobilization, and execution while treating the human person merely as a means. Third, vitality is not equivalent to maturity. A highly mobilizing ontology may remain architecturally primitive. Fourth, contemplative depth is not equivalent to historical projectuality. An ontology may discern foundations while lacking the capacity to create institutions or sustain their realization. Fifth, non-derivativeness is not equivalent to isolation. Subjecthood arises not through the rejection of inheritance and communication but through the responsible appropriation, verification, and creative continuation of what has been received. Sixth, falsifiability is not equivalent to weakness. The willingness to revise one's own configuration testifies not to the absence of a foundation but to the distinction between the Foundation itself and the human ways of holding it.

It follows that a false ontology may possess considerable architectural sophistication, functional effectiveness, and subjective power while remaining fundamentally defective in its foundation and therefore destructive in its overall ontological profile. The multidimensional model thus explains why evil may be intelligent, creative, organized, and historically effective without thereby becoming ontologically sound in the fullest sense.

7.3. The Ontological Profile

The ultimate task of analysis is therefore not to construct a ranking of ontologies but to construct their profiles.

At a minimum, an ontological profile includes:
the architectural capacity and resolving power of Dynamic Iconic Space;
structural maturity and dynamic vitality;
the adequacy and completeness of the functional cycle;
groundedness and transcendent openness;
the capacity for verification, self-correction, and development;
ontological falsifiability and the practice of ontological asceticism;
ontological freedom, non-derivativeness, and projectuality;
responsibility, ontological solvency, and humanity;
historical productivity and the transmission of subjecthood.

8. Ontological Competence as a Transversal Metacompetence

The three dimensions of ontological quality describe different aspects of ontology's potential. Yet potential alone does not guarantee actualization. The unifying condition that enables the Dynamic Iconic Space (DIS), the ontological operating system, and subjecthood to function coherently is ontological competence. Ontological competence is the capacity to distinguish the foundations of human existence, to perceive the relationship between ontology and ontics, to discern ultimate and derivative foundations, to hold contradictions without premature reduction, to examine one's own foundation critically, and to translate ontological understanding into evaluation, decision, and project. Ontological competence is not a fourth dimension of ontological quality. Rather, it is a transversal actualizing capacity that permeates all three dimensions. Within the Dynamic Iconic Space, it enables the subject to perceive and sustain ontological complexity. Within the ontological operating system, it enables productive work with that complexity. Within subjecthood, it enables understanding to become authentic choice, responsibility, and projectuality. Consequently, a deficiency of ontological competence diminishes the effective quality of the entire system. A rich Dynamic Iconic Space remains an unintegrated collection of images; a sophisticated operating system becomes an instrument indifferent to its purpose; the taste for freedom fails to distinguish authenticity from arbitrariness; professional competencies become equally capable of serving either one's own project or someone else's.

In practice, such a deficiency affects every sphere of activity. Intelligence becomes merely instrumental; education is reduced to the accumulation of information; faith degenerates into the reproduction of formulas and rituals; communication becomes an exchange of signals; governance turns into the administration of what already exists; and projectuality becomes the implementation of borrowed models. For this reason, the cultivation of ontological competence must accompany every form of specialized education and create the conditions for its meaningful application. It functions as a transversal metacompetence, determining what all other competencies ultimately serve, the direction in which they are employed, and whether they are capable of converging into autonomous and authentic subjecthood. Responsibility for its formation is distributed among several agents, yet must never become impersonal.

The ontological intelligentsia produces, preserves, and renews ontological competencies together with the language of ontological discernment.

Education forms, on a mass scale, the ability to distinguish foundations, scales, and levels of reality, to recognize the limits of particular models, and to unite

knowledge with responsibility. Its task is not to transmit a single mandatory ontology but to cultivate the competence to engage consciously with ontological foundations.

The Church performs ontological re-addressing, preserving orientation from derivative foundations toward the ultimate Foundation. Yet it can fulfill this function only insofar as it itself preserves living ontological competence rather than reducing it to the ritual reproduction of forms.

Culture, philosophy, and science generate images, concepts, critiques, and alternative models that expand the space of discernment and of the possible.

The state provides the infrastructure necessary for cultivating competence: high-quality education, institutions of memory, freedom for substantive public discourse, and the possibility of critical reflection. It must not monopolize ontological content, otherwise competence degenerates into ideological discipline.

The subject ultimately bears responsibility for appropriating and actualizing this competence. Competence may be transmitted and sustained, but it cannot be exercised on another's behalf.

The canonical formula for the distribution of responsibility is therefore:

The ontological intelligentsia produces and preserves competencies; education transmits them; the Church preserves orientation toward the ultimate Foundation; culture expands the space of the possible; the state provides the necessary infrastructure; and the subject actualizes competence through personal choice and responsibility.

This distribution distinguishes functions without isolating their bearers. Ideally, the Church—or an institution functionally equivalent to it—should serve as the institutional center of the ontological intelligentsia: the place where it gathers, reproduces itself, preserves continuity of experience, and examines the models it generates in relation to the ultimate Foundation.

Such a role does not imply administrative control over thought. On the contrary, the Church can serve as the center of the ontological intelligentsia only insofar as it protects the space of free ontological discernment from reduction to ideology, political expediency, or the service of the existing order.

Here the formula "The Church is the infrastructure of ontological re-addressing" receives its institutional elaboration: re-addressing is accomplished not only through liturgy, dogmatic memory, and spiritual practice, but also through the organized production, preservation, and transmission of ontological competence.

9. Culture, Education, and the Reproduction of Ontologies

Culture is the primary mechanism through which ontologies are reproduced. It transmits not only knowledge, norms, or individual values, but also the very quality of the internal iconic space: its scale, resolution, depth, coherence, hierarchy, images of the past, and scenarios of the future. Language, education, art, literature, religion, historical memory, and social practices shape the sensory apparatus, interpretation, axiology, trigger systems, and navigation of future generations. Cultures, therefore, can be compared not only by their external achievements but also by the quality of ontology they reproduce and by whether they are capable of transmitting the competence required for its further development. Within this perspective, education cannot be reduced to the transmission of information. Its primary task is the formation of ontological competence: increasing the scale and resolving power of

the Dynamic Iconic Space, developing the full functional cycle of ontology, and forming a subject capable of independently discerning and verifying foundations, projecting the future, and assuming responsibility for it. If this task is neglected, deficiencies arise across every dimension of ontological quality, diminishing the value of all subsequent specialization. Culture degenerates when it transmits ready-made answers without the capacity to formulate questions, forms without the competencies required for their reproduction, memory without understanding, identity without responsibility, and mobilization without orientation toward the Foundation. Under such conditions, cargo cults emerge: external forms remain while the Dynamic Iconic Space that originally generated them has already disintegrated.

10. The Actualization of Ontology in the History of the Person and of Society

From this perspective, history may be understood as the history of the emergence, inheritance, development, confrontation, crystallization, re-foundation, and dissolution of ontologies.

This process unfolds simultaneously on two interconnected scales: within the biography of the individual person and within the history of communities, societies, institutions, and civilizations. Neither of these dimensions is secondary.

The individual is formed within collective ontologies yet remains capable of reinterpreting and transforming them. Collective ontology, in turn, exists through persons, yet cannot be reduced to the sum of their individual states.

10.1. The History of the Person

A person's biography may be understood as the history of the emergence, inheritance, confrontation, crisis, transformation, and dissolution of ontological configurations. A person initially receives an ontology largely in an inherited form. Yet throughout life, he may come to recognize its limitations, undergo an ontological crisis, expand his Dynamic Iconic Space, restructure his ontological operating system, undergo re-foundation, and attain a more autonomous and authentic subjecthood. A personal crisis is often a crisis in the quality of ontology. The previous system of images, meanings, and distinctions no longer explains experience; the inherited axiology no longer provides orientation; old modes of interpreting the past obstruct the present; and the person loses the ability to project the future. Outwardly, life may continue to function, while inwardly it enters a state of dead time—the reproduction of what already exists without ontological choice. A personal breakthrough may likewise begin as an ontological explosion—the sudden emergence of a new configuration of meanings, distinctions, and possibilities. Yet the explosion itself is not enough. The new ontology must undergo crystallization: it must acquire language, memory, habits of discernment, practices, decisions, stable patterns of behavior, and the capacity for self-correction. Otherwise, the new vision remains merely an episodic experience rather than becoming a biographical reality. For the individual, the interaction of ontological competence, subjective projectuality, and the ontic environment constitutes a biographical trajectory. A person does not fully create the circumstances of his life, yet the quality of his ontology determines what he is capable of seeing within them, what he regards as significant, what he can transform, what he chooses to resist, and for what he accepts responsibility.

10.2. The History of Collectives and Societies

Historical crises often prove to be crises in the quality of ontology. The existing ontology no longer perceives emerging processes; its interpretations lose adequacy; its axiology ceases to provide direction; institutions of memory continue reproducing models that no longer function; and self-correction becomes blocked. A historical breakthrough begins as an ontological explosion—the emergence of a new configuration of images, meanings, distinctions, and possibilities. Yet to enter history, this breakthrough must complete the full functional cycle: it must acquire language, memory, competencies, projectuality, mobilization, institutions, implementation, and mechanisms of correction. After the initial explosion comes crystallization—the prolonged formation of the new ontology into stable forms. Social entropy manifests itself as the gradual decline of coherence, resolving power, functional effectiveness, and the capacity for re-addressing toward the Foundation. Institutions may continue to exist while no longer fulfilling their original ontological function. Society preserves external activity while simultaneously losing the capacity to generate its own horizon of the future. Historical victory therefore testifies primarily to projectuality, mobilizational capacity, and executive effectiveness, but it does not by itself demonstrate the quality of an ontology's foundation. A historically effective subject may be ontologically impoverished, while the bearer of a deeper ontology may prove incapable of its socio-ontic realization. The minimal formula of history must therefore include three factors:

Ontological competence determines what kind of world the subject is capable of perceiving.

The subject's projectuality — what kind of life or world the subject is capable of designing and building.

The ontic environment determines what actually emerges from that project.

For the individual, the result is a biographical trajectory. For the collective, the result is a socio-historical trajectory. History as a whole is the interaction between the personal and collective processes through which ontology becomes actualized.

11. The Place of the Concept of Ontological Quality within CTM

The concept of the quality of ontology, first introduced in CTM I, receives further development and systematic formulation here. It provides a framework for investigating not only the content of individual and collective ontologies but also the structure of the internal spaces within which human beings become capable of perceiving reality, forming their own response, and introducing that response into biography and history.

The concept links the two fundamental characteristics of understanding—scale and resolving power—with the three dimensions of the ontological profile. The Dynamic Iconic Space shows what reality the subject is capable of holding, and in what form. The ontological operating system shows what the subject is capable of doing with that reality. The subjecthood of ontology shows whether the subject is capable of acting from his own foundation, independently forming evaluations, interpretations, and projects, and accepting responsibility for their consequences.

11.1. History and Governance

From this perspective, history unfolds as the actualization, confrontation, crystallization, re-foundation, and dissolution of ontologies. A historical event ceases to be merely the outcome of resources, institutions, and decisions. It becomes a test of what reality a collective is capable of perceiving, what future it is capable of projecting, and what price it is willing to pay for the realization of that project.

Governance likewise acquires a new meaning. Its task is not limited to administering behavior or allocating resources. The quality of governance depends upon the capacity to perceive both ontics and ontology simultaneously, to formulate goals, mobilize subjects, sustain feedback, and revise the project in response to reality. Here lies the cybernetic potential of CTM: governance may be understood as maintaining the complete cycle of ontological actualization and self-correction.

11.2. Relation to Other Themes within CTM

The study of the quality of ontology directly intersects with the other major themes of CTM. Eschatological subjecthood investigates the orientation of historical creativity. Ontological communication examines the relationship of the subject to the Other and to the Foundation.

The model of ontological quality describes the internal space and the ensemble of capacities through which such orientation and communication become possible. The model may be applied to the individual person, a worldview, a culture, a religious tradition, a society, or a historical project. At the same time, it does not assume that different ontologies can be reduced to a single quantitative scale. Each dimension requires independent analysis, and the result is a multidimensional ontological profile.

Conclusion

The concept of the quality of ontology unites several major themes within CTM: the perception of reality, subjecthood, communication, project formation, action, and orientation toward the Foundation.

It shifts attention away from the content of individual beliefs toward the structure and operative capacity of the internal space within which a person or collective perceives reality, interprets it, and forms a response.

Ontology understood as Dynamic Iconic Space describes the scope, structure, and resolving power of the reality being held.

Ontology understood as an ontological operating system shows how perception and interpretation become project formation and action, and how the resulting action becomes verification and correction.

The subjecthood of ontology reveals whether a person or collective functions as the source of its own system of evaluations, interpretation of the past, and projection of the future, or whether, despite possessing highly developed capacities, it merely reproduces a derivative logic and carries out someone else's projectuality.

For this reason, the vitality of ontology and its subjecthood must always be evaluated separately.

Vitality characterizes the power of actualization, reproduction, and historical action.

Subjecthood characterizes the authorship of the axiological, hermeneutical, and projectual logic governing that action.

Without vitality, a subjective ontology may remain an unrealized possibility.

Without subjecthood, a vital ontology may become an efficient mechanism for reproducing someone else's project.

Ontological competence denotes the capacity to activate all three dimensions of the model in a coherent and integrated manner.

Ontological falsifiability designates the possibility of revising an existing ontological configuration under the influence of reality, the Other, and the Foundation.

Ontological asceticism denotes the subject's practical readiness to accept such revision and, when necessary, to undergo re-foundation.

The proposed model may be summarized as follows:

The Dynamic Iconic Space (DIS) holds and organizes reality → the ontological operating system enables perception, interpretation, project formation, action, and correction → subjecthood determines the autonomous source of evaluation, decision, and project → biography and history become the spaces in which these are embodied and tested.

Such an understanding of the quality of ontology makes it possible to analyze what kind of reality a person or a collective is capable of holding, what they are capable of doing with it, to what extent their action is genuinely their own, and how their ontological configuration is transformed through encounters with reality, the Other, and the Foundation.

Ontogenesis of Subjecthood

The CTM project began with the assumption that the Christian Church constitutes the space in which the human is expressed most fully. Consequently, the search for the nature of the Church inevitably required an investigation into the nature of the human person itself. This investigation was Christocentric in character and was grounded in a corresponding interpretation of the biblical tradition, above all the New Testament.

As the project developed, it became clear that this approach to the study of the human person opened remarkably broad horizons. The most comprehensive conceptual expression of the human being disclosed by the biblical-Christian tradition proved to be the concept of subjecthood. Once the first part of CTM had been completed, the next logical question concerned both the genesis of subjecthood and the process of its formation. The second part of the CTM project is an attempt to answer precisely this question.

Substance-based and nominative metaphysics, which viewed the world primarily as an aggregate of substances, things, and their properties, eventually encountered the limits of its own explanatory model. Some philosophical movements interpreted this crisis as a crisis of metaphysics itself and even proclaimed its end. Yet what had reached exhaustion was not metaphysics as such but rather one particular mode of metaphysical inquiry.

In this respect, processual-verbal metaphysics, which understands reality in terms of interaction, becoming, and the mutual transformation of processes—while regarding states as relatively stable modes of those processes—offers a particularly fruitful alternative.

When the traditional questions "What exists?" and "What is this thing?" are supplemented by the questions "What is happening?" and "How does something arise, exist, endure, change, and cease to be?", it becomes evident that the potential of classical metaphysics is far from exhausted and is capable of entering a new and productive stage of development.

The processual understanding of the human person already present in the first part of CTM is therefore made explicit and systematically developed in the second part into a processual-verbal metaphysics, which serves as the methodological foundation of the present investigation.

This methodology makes it possible to move beyond merely terminological descriptions of categories and instead disclose reality through the analysis of the actions, interactions, and transformations of its agents.

It is impossible—and the methodology of CTM does not even attempt—to exclude one's own historical experience entirely from the investigation.

The comparison of the historical experience of the North Caucasus with the Christian tradition reveals a common pattern: neither an individual nor a community becomes a subject automatically.

They may possess consciousness, identity, will, and formal institutions while nevertheless remaining incapable of accepting reality, occupying their own position, acting responsibly, and maintaining their relationship with reality.

CTM designates the capacity of a person or a community to become a subject, to actualize this mode of existence, and to preserve it by the concept of subjecthood.

For this reason, subjecthood has become one of the central categories of the project.

If subjecthood is not given automatically to either individuals or communities, it becomes necessary to determine the initial conditions from which it arises, the processes through which it is formed, the manner in which it is appropriated and sustained, the reasons for which it may be lost, and the new horizons of human development that it makes possible.

The investigation of this sequence constitutes the subject of the ontogenesis of subjecthood.

The problem of the birth—or genesis—of subjecthood has been examined in detail in a separate study.

Here it is sufficient to note that the acknowledgment of reality together with the acceptance of responsibility for responding to it transforms the human being from one who has been begun into one who begins.

It is with this transition that the subject-existence of the human person begins.

Yet the birth of the subject is only the beginning of a far more extended process.

In the present study, we shall attempt to trace the entire trajectory of the development of human subjecthood.

Part I. The Formation of Ontic Subjecthood

1. The Acceptance of Reality

1.1. Reality Precedes the Subject

The first condition of subjecthood is the acceptance that reality is not created by human decision and is under no obligation to conform to human desire. Prior to every project, the human person encounters the world, other people, his own body, time, causality, limitations, and consequences. He enters a history that has already begun and finds himself within relationships that he did not choose.

The acceptance of reality does not mean passive acquiescence to everything that exists. Rather, it means acknowledging reality's right to falsify our representations. As long as a person accepts only what confirms his desires, he is dealing not with reality but with his own projection. Thus, the primary capacity of the subject is paradoxical: it begins not with acting upon the world but with the willingness to allow the world to act upon oneself.

Such acceptance includes at least four elements.

First, the distinction between fact and desire: what exists does not cease to exist simply because it is painful.

Second, the acknowledgment of the limits of one's own knowledge.

Third, the willingness to hear the Other as the bearer of a message that cannot be reduced to one's own expectations.

Fourth, the readiness to take the consequences of one's actions into account.

1.2. Why the Denial of Reality Destroys Subjecthood

The denial of reality may appear to be an expression of freedom, as though a person refuses to acknowledge externally imposed limits. Yet if he excludes the possibility of external verification, his action ceases to be corrigible. The will closes in upon itself, choice becomes merely the repetition of desire, and every project becomes an extension of fantasy. Such activity may be energetic, yet it remains devoid of subjecthood in the sense that it does not constitute a response to reality.

The subject emerges precisely where, between reality's impact and the human response, there opens a space for perception, discernment, and decision.

The denial of reality destroys the first element of this structure.

The person then has nothing to respond to except his own existing configuration.

1.3. The Result of the First Stage

The result of accepting reality is minimal falsifiability: the acknowledgment that my understanding may be mistaken, my desire may be impossible or destructive, and the Other may not correspond to my image of the Other.

This is not yet subjecthood, but it is an indispensable condition for its emergence.

The next question arises precisely because the accepted reality includes the human person himself: if the world is not given to me entirely according to my own will, then my own beginning is likewise not my own creation.

2. The Acceptance of One's Own Beginning

2.1. The Given Character of Existence

A person does not choose the fact of his birth, his body, his original family, the language of his childhood, the place of his birth, his initial cultural environment, or much of his early history.

He does not create the original material of his existence.

Subjecthood therefore begins not with the formula "I produce myself," but with the recognition:

"I already exist, and I receive myself as a task."

The acceptance of one's own beginning embraces one's body, origin, language, memory, biography, abilities, wounds, limitations, and relationships.

None of these elements should be regarded as an absolute destiny.

Yet neither can any of them simply be erased without consequence.

Even a limitation that has been overcome remains part of the history of its overcoming.

2.2. To Accept Does Not Mean to Justify or Preserve

Acceptance is often mistaken for approval.

Yet a person may accept the fact of evil inflicted upon him without declaring evil to be good; he may accept illness while continuing to seek healing; he may accept his historical inheritance while refusing to reproduce its destructive forms.

To accept means to cease expending subjective energy on pretending that a fact never existed and instead to incorporate it into responsible action.

The opposite error consists in transforming one's accepted beginning into an immutable essence.

Origin determines the starting point, but it does not exhaust the future.

If a person dissolves completely into what he has received, he remains merely derivative from the past.

If he rejects it completely, he loses the material from which his own identity is formed.

Subjecthood emerges through responsible continuation: what has been received is neither idolized nor discarded but accepted as a possibility entrusted to one's care.

2.3. The Response to the Gift of Existence

The first genuinely subjective impulse may be described as the response to the gift.

Here the word gift does not refer to an emotionally pleasant experience but to the fact that one is not the author of one's own beginning.

I am not the cause of my own existence.

Therefore, my first act is not the creation of myself out of nothing but a response to what has already been given.

The formula of this stage may therefore be expressed as follows:

The subject's first act is not creation but consent to exist.

This consent does not complete the task; it makes the task possible.

The person accepts himself not as a finished result but as an unfinished beginning whose continuation has now become his own responsibility.

3. The Interiorization of the Question of One's Own Being

3.1. From the External Question to the Internal One

To accept existence is not yet to understand it.

The next stage begins when the question of being ceases to be merely an abstract philosophical problem and turns toward the one who asks it:

Τί τὸ ὄν ἐν ἐμοί;

What is being within me?

This question cannot be reduced to the psychological inquiry, "What do I feel?", nor to the social question, "Who do others think I am?"

Rather, it concerns the mode in which being is present within me:

What within me has been received? What has been appropriated? What acts through me? What do I allow to determine my decisions? And what can truly be called my own?

3.2. Why the Question Must Be Interiorized

A person may construct profound theories about the Foundations of reality while never subjecting his own life to examination. In such a case, ontology remains merely external knowledge.

Interiorization abolishes this distance: the question concerning the Foundation of the world simultaneously becomes the question concerning the Foundation of my own mode of existence.

From this arises ontological reflexivity—the capacity to notice not only individual convictions but also the inner architecture from which they arise.

The person begins to ask:

Why does this seem self-evident to me?

Whose system of distinctions am I reproducing?

Which Foundation actually governs my fears, my fidelity, and my hope?

3.3. The Transition to the Hermeneutics of Beginning

The question itself does not yet provide an answer.

The given beginning admits different interpretations: the body may be experienced as a gift, an accident, a prison, or an instrument; one's origin as a vocation, a trauma, a privilege, or an indifferent fact; history as destiny, the material of freedom, or the foundation of revenge.

The next inevitable act is therefore the choice of the hermeneutics of one's own beginning.

4. The Choice of the Hermeneutics of Beginning

4.1. The Given Never Enters Life Without Interpretation

A person responds not to a "pure fact" but to a fact that has already been incorporated into a structure of meaning.

The same original givenness may generate radically different life trajectories depending upon how it is interpreted.

The hermeneutics of beginning is the way in which the received past is connected with the possible future.

Its choice is not always conscious.

A child initially accepts the ready-made explanations offered by family and culture.

Later these explanations may continue to function as an invisible program.

The emergence of subjecthood requires making this program visible, distinguishing the event itself from its inherited interpretation, and asking which interpretation can withstand an encounter with reality.

4.2. The Principal False Hermeneutics

The first false possibility is the hermeneutics of determinism:

"What I have received completely determines who I am."

It abolishes responsibility for continuation.

The second is the hermeneutics of denial:

"My beginning has nothing to do with me."

It creates a rupture between biography and self-understanding.

The third is the hermeneutics of privilege:

"My origin already justifies me and gives me authority over the Other."

The fourth is the hermeneutics of resentment:

"The evil done to me gives me a permanent right to reproduce evil."

In every one of these cases, the person remains under the power of his beginning—even when attempting to deny it.

The hermeneutics of subjecthood does not abolish the causality of the past; rather, it distinguishes conditioning from ultimate determination.

It says:

"This happened to me and continues to act within me, yet my response is not exhausted by what has happened."

4.3. The Hermeneutics of Gift and Task

Within CTM, the productive hermeneutic understands one's beginning simultaneously as gift and task.

Gift points to what has been received.

Task points to what remains unfinished.

This dual perspective allows one neither to claim authorship of one's beginning nor to renounce authorship of its continuation.

It is precisely here that the transition from interpretation to responsibility occurs.

If what has been received constitutes the material of a possible response, then I must decide not only what it means but also what I shall do with it.

5. The Hermeneutics of Responsibility

5.1. Responsibility as the Authorship of the Response

Within this architecture, responsibility does not begin with guilt.

Its primary meaning is the capacity and obligation to give one's own response to the reality one has received.

A person is not responsible for the fact of his birth, but he is responsible for the manner in which he continues his life.

He is not responsible for everything that has been done to him, but he is responsible for what he makes of what he has endured.

He does not choose the entirety of the language he inherits, yet he is responsible for the truth or falsehood he speaks through that language.

This understanding avoids two opposite extremes.

The first holds a person responsible for everything, including what he could never have chosen.

The second recognizes responsibility only for completely autonomous acts and thereby frees the person from almost all responsibility, since absolute autonomy does not exist.

CTM locates responsibility between givenness and response.

5.2. The Expansion of the Sphere of One's Own Response

As subjecthood develops, the sphere of responsibility expands.

Initially, a person is responsible for immediate actions.

Later he becomes responsible for enduring habits, chosen interpretations, the range of acceptable means, the consequences of the institutions he creates, and the future he projects.

Gradually, he comes to acknowledge as his own not merely his intentions but also the very architecture that consistently produces those intentions.

This marks the transition from episodic morality to ontological responsibility.

The decisive question is no longer merely,

"Did I act rightly?"

but rather,

"What mode of existence produced this action?"

5.3. The Possibility of Refusal

At this stage, subjecthood may be rejected through the transfer of authorship:

"That's how things are done."

"That's how the system works."

"I was ordered to do it."

"History left me no choice."

Such explanations may accurately point to genuine constraints.

They become destructive, however, when they eliminate the space of response altogether.

Subjecthood does not require omnipotence.

It requires discovering that part of the response which genuinely belongs to the person and refusing to surrender it to external forces.

6. The Acceptance of Oneself

6.1. From Accepting Facts to Accepting the Bearer of History

The acceptance of one's own beginning concerns one's original givenness.

The acceptance of oneself is a later and more demanding act.

A person accepts not only what has happened to him but also himself as the concrete bearer of that history—including his choices, mistakes, abilities, and unfinishedness.

Here the distinction between acknowledging individual facts and integrating the person becomes evident.

One may acknowledge one's origin while continuing to hate the person that origin has made one become.

One may admit a mistake while excluding the mistaken self from one's own identity.

In such a case, biography disintegrates into accepted and rejected fragments.

6.2. The Acceptance of Oneself Is Not Self-Satisfaction

To accept oneself does not mean declaring one's present condition to be the norm.

On the contrary, change becomes possible only when the subject acknowledges:

It is I myself who must be transformed—not an imaginary double.

Self-rejection often disguises a refusal of responsibility.

If the "real me" has nothing to do with what has been done, then no one is required to transform the configuration that produced the act.

The acceptance of oneself unites truth and continuity.

A person permits a truthful description of himself, even when it is painful, while at the same time refusing to relinquish authorship of his future response.

6.3. The Result of This Stage

The result is biographical integration: the capacity to say,

"This is my history,"

without reducing oneself to any single moment within it.

Upon this foundation becomes possible identity with oneself—not a static immutability, but an enduring fidelity to the responsibility one has accepted.

7. Identity with Oneself

7.1. Identity as the Continuity of the Response

Identity with oneself does not mean remaining the same over time.

A person changes, revises his convictions, and may even undergo re-foundation.

Identity consists in not losing authorship of this trajectory: in being able to connect the former and the new, acknowledge discontinuity, explain one's transformation, and accept its consequences.

Such identity stands opposed both to opportunism and to obstinacy.

Opportunism changes positions in response to external pressure and thereby conceals the absence of its own foundation.

Obstinacy preserves an earlier configuration despite reality and mistakes the inability to undergo correction for faithfulness.

The identity of subjecthood embraces change precisely for the sake of a deeper fidelity to reality and to the Foundation.

7.2. Identity and One's Own Voice

One's own voice does not emerge when a person says something that has never before been said.

It emerges when he responsibly appropriates the language, tradition, and foundations of his speech.

What has been inherited may become genuinely one's own through understanding, verification, and the acceptance of responsibility.

Conversely, an original formulation may remain derivative if its logic is dictated merely by the desire for external recognition.

Identity with oneself is therefore a prerequisite for communication.

Only one who can preserve his own position while at the same time allowing it to be verified is capable of encountering the Other without dissolving into him or reducing him to an object.

8. Ontic Subjecthood

8.1. Definition

Ontic subjecthood is the capacity of a person to become a responsible source of decision and action within the sphere of concrete lived reality.

Its fundamental question is:

Who am I, and for what am I responsible in my own life?

It includes the acceptance of one's body and biography, the ability to distinguish fact from desire, the integration of one's past, steadfastness in decision, practical action, and the acceptance of consequences.

At this level, a person may not yet analyze the ultimate Foundations of history, yet he has already ceased to be merely an object of circumstances.

8.2. Why Ontic Subjecthood Is Necessary for All Subsequent Levels

The absence of ontic subjecthood cannot be compensated for by lofty metaphysical ideas.

A person incapable of taking responsibility for his word, his time, his promises, and his immediate actions may speak about Foundations, yet his ontology never enters life.

The subsequent levels do not abolish everyday responsibility; they expand its scope.

Ontic subjecthood therefore constitutes the first integrated form of the entire architecture.

Within it, the acceptance of reality, the hermeneutics of beginning, responsibility, the acceptance of oneself, and identity with oneself converge into the capacity to act in one's own name.

8.3. The Limits of the Ontic Horizon

Ontic subjecthood nevertheless remains confined to the horizon of concrete situations.

It enables a person to solve problems successfully within an existing system of coordinates, yet it does not necessarily ask why that very system is constituted as it is.

The transition to the next level begins through communication.

Action reveals the Other, and the encounter with the Other calls into question not merely an individual decision but the very conditions of our understanding of reality.

9. Ontic Communication

9.1. Communication as Exchange within a Shared Reality

Ontic communication is the exchange of messages, actions, resources, and obligations within a world that is already shared.

People negotiate, communicate facts, coordinate work, express emotions, debate means, and distribute responsibilities.

It is not "lower" in any pejorative sense.

Without it, neither family, nor labor, nor institutions, nor everyday solidarity would be possible.

Through it, the subject learns precision, fidelity to promises, trust, and attentiveness to the response of the Other.

9.2. The Other as the Limit of Self-Enclosure

Communication tests subjecthood.

If the Other is acknowledged only insofar as he confirms my picture of the world, genuine communication never takes place.

Ontic communication becomes the communication of subjecthood when the message of the Other is admitted as an independent fact capable of changing my own action.

It is here that ontological empathy first emerges: the capacity not merely to experience the emotions of the Other but to reconstruct the inner space from which his position acquires its meaning.

Such empathy does not yet imply agreement.

It signifies a refusal to reduce the Other to a function within one's own system.

9.3. Beyond the Shared Vocabulary

Sooner or later, communication encounters a conflict that cannot be resolved merely by clarifying facts.

The parties understand the human person, justice, freedom, history, or truth in fundamentally different ways.

It then becomes evident that the disagreement is no longer taking place within a shared worldview but between different worldviews.

This opens the way toward the question of the Foundations.

Part II. Ontological Breakthrough and the Emergence of the Historical Subject

10. Ontological Breakthrough

10.1. The Event of Breakthrough

An ontological breakthrough occurs when a person realizes that events and decisions are organized by deeper conceptions of reality.

Behind a political order there stands a particular ontology of the human person.

Behind economic relations lies an understanding of property, labor, and value.

Behind culture stands a hierarchy of meaning.

Behind historical conflicts lie incompatible ways of grounding the world.

The central question changes.

Instead of asking,

"What happened?"

one begins to ask,

"Why does such a thing become possible at all, and what Foundation makes it meaningful?"

The person begins to think not only in terms of things and events but also in terms of the Foundations of things and the conditions of events.

The breakthrough also embraces the one who asks.

He discovers that his own responses are likewise generated by an inner ontology.

Thus the question,

Τί τὸ ὄν ἐν ἐμοί;

acquires a new dimension:

Which Foundation is at work within me and through me?

10.2. Ontological Explosion

If the breakthrough marks the discovery of the dimension of Foundations, ontological explosion is the moment in which former self-evidences rapidly collapse.

An isolated contradiction ceases to appear as a local error and instead reveals a defect in the entire system.

Former meanings lose their self-evidence, relationships are reconfigured, and a multitude of facts suddenly acquires an entirely different explanation.

An ontological explosion may take the form of religious conversion, philosophical discovery, scientific revolution, political awakening, or biographical crisis.

Its defining characteristic is not the change of a single opinion but the transformation of the very space within which opinions are formed.

An explosion, however, guarantees nothing by itself.

The collapse of a former worldview may open a person to reality, but it may equally render him susceptible to a simpler and more totalizing ideology.

For this reason, a prolonged process of crystallization begins after the explosion.

11. Why an Ontological Breakthrough Does Not Yet Mean Truth

11.1. Discovering Depth and Navigating Within It

A strict distinction must be made between two phenomena:

ontological breakthrough — the discovery of the dimension of Foundations;

ontological competence — the ability to navigate within that dimension.

A person may correctly recognize that the existing order is not accidental while incorrectly identifying its Foundation.

He may uncover the derivative character of accepted norms only to absolutize another derivative norm.

He may grasp the projectual character of history and conclude that history is entirely subject to his own project.

The great revolutionaries and architects of total ideologies often suffered not from a lack of ontological thinking but from a powerful yet reduced vision of the Foundations.

Their danger lay in combining profound explanation with closure to falsification.

11.2. Criteria for Initial Verification

After a breakthrough, at least four tests become necessary.

The first is the test of scope: How much of reality can the model actually hold, and what is it forced to dismiss as insignificant?

The second is the test of resolution: Does it distinguish between phenomena that are closely related but not identical?

The third is the test of the Other: Does it preserve the Other as a subject, or does it reduce the Other to material for its own scheme?

The fourth is the test of falsifiability: Are there circumstances under which the model would acknowledge the need for correction?

If these tests are blocked, the breakthrough quickly turns into a new form of closure.

The person leaves one system of self-evidences only to enter another.

12. Ontological Communication

12.1. Communication Between Spaces of Foundations

Ontological communication begins where the object of encounter is no longer merely facts and decisions but the very ways in which reality is grounded.

Subjects communicate not merely what they think but from what space of distinctions and fidelity their thinking arises.

Its purpose is not immediately to eliminate difference but to make the Foundations of each side visible.

This requires a language capable of distinguishing the level of the event, the interpretation, the value, the derivative foundation, and the supreme Foundation.

Without such distinctions, discussion continually shifts from one level to another.

12.2. Conditions of Ontological Communication

The first condition is identity with oneself: the subject must possess a position that he is capable of presenting.

The second is falsifiability: he allows for the possibility that the encounter may transform him.

The third is ontological empathy: he seeks to understand the inner architecture of the Other from within.

The fourth is the distinction between understanding and agreement.

To understand another's foundation is not to accept it.

To reject it is not to refuse to understand it.

The fifth condition is a fidelity to reality that surpasses fidelity to one's own formulation.

If preserving one's position becomes more important than truth itself, communication degenerates into a struggle for domination.

12.3. The Result of Communication

Ontological communication may confirm an existing foundation, refine it, reveal the limits of its applicability, or lead to re-foundation.

In every case, however, it expands the actual interiorized space.

The subject begins to hold not only his own model but also the possibility of other models and the relationships among them.

Out of communication there may emerge a shared act that is no longer reducible to the sum of individual actions.

13. The Act of Society

13.1. When a Multitude Becomes a Subject

A collective exists in fact before it becomes a subject.

People may live side by side, share common interests, and submit to the same administration without yet possessing a common response of their own.

The act of society occurs when communication produces a shared distinction of reality, a common decision, and a jointly accepted responsibility for its realization.

This is not the mystical emergence of a supra-personal being.

Rather, it is a new configuration of relationships.

Decisions begin to arise within the space of a shared memory, language, values, and project, while the participants recognize themselves as jointly responsible for the whole.

13.2. The Structure of the Act

The act of society unfolds through the following sequence:

a shared reality is recognized;

a common question is articulated;

the Foundation that gives the question its meaning is identified;

a common decision is produced;

responsibility is distributed;

action begins;

a mechanism for verifying the result is established.

Without a common question, the collective remains merely an audience.

Without its own decision, it becomes a mobilization resource for another subject.

Without distributed responsibility, the decision remains a declaration.

Without verification, the original act quickly degenerates into a ritual of repetition.

13.3. The Limits of Mass Mobilization

Mass participation alone does not prove subjecthood.

A crowd may be extraordinarily active while remaining entirely derivative.

The decisive criterion is therefore not the intensity of mobilization but the authorship of the collective axiological, hermeneutical, and projectual logic.

Who determined what is valuable?

Who interpreted the past?

Who formed the image of the future?

Whose projectuality is the mobilization actually serving?

The act of society creates the possibility of collective subjecthood, but its permanence depends upon crystallization.

14. The Crystallization of a New Ontology

14.1. From Event to Structure

An ontological explosion may occur in an instant, but a new ontology does not emerge fully formed.

Crystallization is the prolonged process through which a new Foundation reshapes language, memory, the hierarchy of values, practices, institutions, and the image of the future.

It begins immediately after the breakthrough but unfolds unevenly.

A person may already confess a new Foundation while continuing to perceive himself through old categories.

A society may adopt a new political order while preserving its former patterns of trust and power.

For this reason, a merely declarative change of ideas is not yet an ontological transformation.

14.2. The Stages of Crystallization

First, a new point of distinction appears: the subject begins to perceive one crucial aspect of reality differently.

Next, this new distinction spreads into neighboring domains.

Then language itself is reassembled: old words acquire new meanings, and new concepts emerge.

Afterward, memory is transformed: the past is reread from the perspective of the new Foundation.

Then the axiology of the present is reshaped, and the space of a possible future is opened.

Finally, the new distinctions become embodied in repeatable practices and institutions.

Crystallization is never completed absolutely.

Every living ontology continues to encounter new realities and to undergo correction.

Complete closure is therefore not a sign of maturity but the loss of falsifiability.

14.3. The Risk of Premature Crystallization

Following an ontological explosion, the subject naturally seeks to restore coherence as quickly as possible. This creates the temptation to mistake the first internally consistent system for final truth.

Crystallization then hardens into ossification: new formulations become shielded from reality, while the original breakthrough is reduced to a dogmatized memory of the event itself.

Mature crystallization must simultaneously establish stability and preserve the channel of correction.

15. Messianic Identity

15.1. From Existence to Mission

When a person or a community discovers the Foundations of history and relates its own existence to them, a new question inevitably arises:

What place do I occupy in history, and for the sake of what task do I exist?

The answer gives rise to messianic identity.

Its fundamental formula changes from

"I exist," to "I exist for the sake of a historical task."

A person ceases to live exclusively for private interests and begins to perceive their own life as the fulfillment of a mission entrusted to them.

15.2. The Ontological Neutrality of Mission

Messianic identity is not identical with religiosity, holiness, or truth.

It may be equally powerful in an apostle, a revolutionary, a national hero, a fanatic, or a dictator.

The category describes the structure of one's relation to oneself, not the validity of the mission's Foundation.

It is precisely this neutrality that makes the concept analytically indispensable.

Self-sacrifice cannot be regarded as proof of truth.

A person may sincerely sacrifice himself for a false Foundation.

The stronger the sense of mission, the more decisive becomes the question of to whom or to what that mission is addressed.

15.3. The Transition to the Fundamental Fork

Messianic identity intensifies the mobilization of subjecthood, yet at the same time it greatly increases the danger of self-absolutization.

The subject is now prepared to subordinate his life to a mission.

The decisive question therefore becomes:

Which Foundation shall receive that fidelity?

It is precisely here that the gravity of onticity manifests itself.

16. The Gravity of Onticity

16.1. Definition

The gravity of onticity is the structural force of attraction exercised by derivative foundations that are immediate, concrete, and historically effective.

Nation, class, state, race, market, civilization, culture, and even the Church—when understood merely as a historical institution—are all real and necessary within their proper limits.

Yet each of them is capable of demanding absolute fidelity.

The danger lies not in the existence of derivative foundations but in the ontologization of onticity—the transformation of what is relative and derivative into what is ultimate and self-sufficient.

16.2. Why Onticity Attracts

Derivative foundations stand closer to us than the supreme Foundation.

They are tangible, emotionally charged, embodied in symbols, territories, institutions, and concrete communities.

Through them it is easy to organize action, identify an enemy, distribute resources, and present a vision of victory.

The supreme Foundation does not permit itself to be appropriated and used as an instrument so easily.

The gravity of onticity is therefore not merely an intellectual mistake.

A person may theoretically distinguish different levels of foundations while practically giving ultimate fidelity to the nearest one.

Its overcoming requires not a single conclusion but a sustained practice of ontological readdressing.

16.3. Signs of Captivity to a Derivative Foundation

The first sign is that the derivative foundation no longer permits evaluation from outside itself: whatever serves the nation, the party, or the institution is automatically declared good.

The second is that the Other is reduced to either a resource or an obstacle.

The third is that the future is imagined as the final triumph of one's own historical form.

The fourth is that criticism becomes indistinguishable from betrayal.

The fifth is that the foundation no longer serves truth; instead, truth is defined by service to the foundation.

It is precisely here that ontological navigation becomes indispensable.

17. Two Independent Coordinates of Historical Subjecthood

17.1. Why a Single Scale Is Insufficient

A historical subject cannot be placed upon a single continuum ranging from weak to strong or from primitive to advanced.

The depth of understanding and the capacity to transform reality are relatively independent.

Profound competence may remain without action, while immense projective power may serve a radically reduced ontology.

Two coordinates must therefore be distinguished:

ontological competence;

socio-ontic projectuality.

17.2. Ontological Competence

Ontological competence is the capacity to navigate within the space of Foundations.

It includes the ability to distinguish the supreme Foundation from derivative foundations, to understand the limits of applicability of models, to exercise ontological reflexivity, ontological empathy, openness to correction, and fidelity to reality.

Its two fundamental parameters are scope and resolution.

Scope indicates how much reality can be held simultaneously: an individual situation, a biography, a society, history, a plurality of cultures, or the relationship between onticity and the Foundation.

Resolution indicates how finely the subject distinguishes levels, relationships, and non-identical phenomena within that scope.

Great scope without resolution produces totalizing schemes in which the concrete human person disappears.

High resolution without scope yields an exceptionally refined analysis of fragments while remaining incapable of perceiving their place within the whole.

Competence requires the simultaneous development of both.

17.3. Socio-Ontic Projectuality

Socio-ontic projectuality is the capacity to translate ontological vision into the transformation of social and historical reality.

It includes goal-setting, the formation of an image of the future, the selection of means, mobilization, organization, institution-building, execution, feedback, and correction.

Its primary question is not,

"What is true?"

but rather,

"What must be done in order for a particular possibility to become reality?"

Projectuality therefore does not arise automatically from competence.

The vision of a Foundation does not, by itself, produce strategy, institutions, or the discipline of execution.

17.4. Four Possible Configurations

Low competence combined with low projectuality leaves the subject enclosed within someone else's onticity.

High competence with low projectuality produces a contemplative bearer of profound insight who is unable to embody that insight historically.

Low competence with high projectuality produces a powerful mechanism of historical transformation that is easily captured by a false Foundation.

A high development of both coordinates creates the greatest possible historical effectiveness, yet even this still requires evaluation according to its orientation toward the Foundation.

Thus, the quality of power is not determined by power alone.

One must know what the subject sees, what the subject is capable of accomplishing, and to what Foundation that accomplishment is ultimately addressed.

18. The Formation of the Historical Project

18.1. From Mission to Project

Mission provides direction, but it does not contain a ready-made project.

To enter history, the subject must translate that mission into a concrete sequence of goals, means, institutions, and criteria of verification.

This translation constitutes the process of historical project formation.

First, an image of the desired future is formed.

Next, the limitations and resources of the present are identified.

Then a space of alternatives is constructed, the possible paths are compared, one of them is chosen, responsibility is distributed, implementation begins, and feedback is organized.

18.2. One's Own Projectuality and Derivative Projectuality

A project is not one's own simply because it has been created in isolation.

Every subject inherits languages, technologies, and models.

Authentic projectuality arises when what has been inherited is responsibly appropriated, verified against one's own reality, and incorporated into a decision whose authorship the subject accepts.

A derivative project may nevertheless be carried out with great energy.

A collective may become highly mobilized, build institutions, and make sacrifices, while its image of the future, its system of values, and its criteria of success all belong to an external subject.

Historical activity alone, therefore, does not demonstrate historical subjecthood.

18.3. Developing the Toolkit for One's Own Project of the Future

To formulate and implement one's own project of the future, a subject needs a projective toolkit of its own. Having an image of a desirable future, and even being capable of formulating a historical project, does not yet imply the ability either to develop that project adequately or to translate it into social and historical reality. Between the initial vision of the future and its implementation lies a distinct domain of the subject's activity: the development of the toolkit for formulating one's own project of the future.

Such a toolkit includes conceptual systems, languages of description, ways of framing questions, models of the human being and society, historical analogies, knowledge and competencies, methods of project design, organizational forms, institutions, technologies, educational practices, methods of mobilization, communication networks, and feedback mechanisms. These enable the subject not only to implement an already formulated goal, but also to envision a possible future that, without the corresponding toolkit, could not have been formulated as a project in the first place.

The relationship between project and toolkit is therefore not unidirectional. The available toolkit determines the space of the future that the subject is capable of envisioning and projecting; the formulated project, in turn, reveals the inadequacy of the existing toolkit and poses the task of expanding it. Projectuality develops through the reciprocal refinement of the image of the future and the means of its formulation and implementation.

A toolkit of one's own need not have been created by the subject itself. Like one's own projectuality, it may be formed through appropriation. Philosophical traditions, religions, ideologies, sciences, other societies, and preceding historical projects can transmit accumulated ways of understanding and transforming reality. Such a toolkit becomes one's own when it has been internalized, tested against one's own ontic reality, and incorporated into a project whose authorship and responsibility the subject accepts.

A particular advantage of serious ideological traditions may consist precisely in their possession of such an accumulated toolkit. A developed ideology can transmit not only a normative image of a desirable future, but also a toolkit for its independent formulation: a language of description, methods for diagnosing the present, models of the human being and society, historical experience, methods of organization, institutional solutions, and practices of mobilization. In this sense, ideological groundedness can expand the subject's historical capacity for action by providing it with the means for formulating its own project of the future.

Here, however, it is necessary to distinguish between the toolkit of projectuality and another's projectuality. Along with the means, the subject may receive a ready-made image of the future, a system of priorities, and criteria of success. In such a case, a high degree of executive capacity may coexist with the derivative character of

the project itself. The task of subjecthood consists in the ability to appropriate the toolkit without thereby transferring the authorship of one's own historical response to another subject.

The highest level of projectuality becomes apparent when the available toolkit proves insufficient for the chosen future. The subject must be capable not only of selecting, appropriating, and combining existing means, but also of creating those that are lacking: new concepts, competencies, institutions, methods, technologies, languages of description, and organizational forms. Here projectuality becomes generative: the subject forms not only the future, but also the means through which that future first becomes projectable and realizable.

Historical capacity for action is therefore determined not only by the possession of one's own project, but also by the ability to develop or subjectively appropriate the toolkit for formulating and implementing one's own project of the future and, when necessary, to create the missing toolkit in the very process of project design.

18.4. The Verification of the Project

A project must be verified on three levels.

Ontically: Does it achieve its stated goals, and does it take its consequences into account?

Ontologically: Does it preserve the understanding of the human person and of reality from which it derives its meaning?

Eschatologically: Does it refrain from allowing a finite historical form to occupy the place of the supreme Foundation?

Without the first verification, the project becomes fantasy.

Without the second, it becomes an efficient mechanism of dehumanization.

Without the third, it becomes social eschatology.

19. Social Eschatology as the Failure of Historical Subjecthood

19.1. The Attempt to Complete History by Means of History

Social eschatology arises whenever the historical subject seeks to establish a final state of the world in which the fundamental contradiction is overcome by means of history itself.

Communism, National Socialism, and other totalizing utopias differ in content but share the same structure: a particular social form is granted the status of ultimate fulfillment.

This is not the product of an absence of ontological thinking.

On the contrary, social eschatology usually combines messianic identity, a powerful explanation of the deep structure of history, and exceptionally high projectuality.

Its defect lies in its orientation:

a derivative foundation usurps the place of the supreme Foundation.

19.2. The Three Components of the Failure

The first component is a mission demanding total mobilization.

The second is the unresolved gravity of onticity, which transforms class, nation, state, or a particular social model into an absolute.

The third is projectuality capable of imposing that ontology upon society.

The greater the projectuality, the more destructive an error of orientation becomes.

For this reason, eschatological verification is required not instead of historical action but precisely because of its power.

19.3. Why a Final Model Closes Reality

Once a project is proclaimed to be the completion of history, every fact contradicting it begins to be interpreted as a remnant of the past, an act of sabotage, or the work of an enemy.

Falsifiability is blocked.

The Other is reduced to an obstacle.

Violence is justified in the name of a supposedly definitive future.

Thus historical subjecthood, which originally sought to liberate the human person, begins instead to destroy the very space of that person's own response.

Part III. Eschatological Subjecthood

20. The Limit of History

20.1. History Is Not the Ultimate Horizon

As long as history is regarded as the ultimate horizon, its success can be made to justify any means, while its failure can appear to be the definitive loss of meaning.

Eschatological subjecthood begins with the recognition that no historical form exhausts the fulfillment of human existence.

The fundamental question therefore changes.

It is no longer merely,

"What future ought we to build?"

but also,

"For the sake of what ultimate fulfillment does history itself exist?"

This question does not abolish projectuality.

Rather, it deprives projectuality of the right to absolutize itself.

20.2. Eschatological Subjecthood and Historical Subjecthood

Historical subjecthood chooses, concretizes, and realizes a project.

It acts within the conditions of time, limited resources, and competing possibilities.

Eschatological subjecthood does not replace this work with a ready-made blueprint for history.

Its function is different:

to preserve orientation toward the Foundation, to expand the space of possible metaphysical models, and to prevent any particular project from declaring itself final.

The relationship between these levels may be expressed as follows:

Foundation → Eschatological Subjecthood → the Space of Possible Metaphysical Models → Historical Subjecthood → a Concrete Historical Project → Ontic Realization

The Foundation enters onticity not as one ontic object among others, nor as the direct cause of a particular political decision.

Rather, it acts through the architecture of projectuality:

it opens the horizon of the possible, orients choice, limits absolutization, and receives concrete historical expression through the response of the subject.

21. Ontological Readdressing

21.1. Changing the Addressee of Ultimate Fidelity

The eschatological transition consists in the readdressing of ultimate fidelity.

The subject ceases to direct it toward nation, class, state, ideology, institution, or his own project, and instead directs it toward the supreme Foundation.

This does not require the rejection of derivative foundations.

The nation may continue to serve as the sphere of historical responsibility.

The state may remain an instrument of common action.

The Church may continue to exist as a real historical community and institution.

Yet none of them acquires the right to define the good solely in terms of its own preservation.

21.2. Readdressing as a Repeated Act

The gravity of onticity does not disappear after one correct philosophical conclusion.

Again and again, the nearest foundation demands absolute loyalty—especially in times of threat, success, or collective mobilization.

For this reason, readdressing must not be a single decision but a repeated practice.

Every major project therefore requires the following questions:

What does our action actually serve?

What is the true ultimate object of our fidelity?

What are we unwilling to sacrifice even for the sake of success?

Can reality and the Other falsify the means we have chosen?

Has service to the Foundation become the use of the name of the Foundation for the sake of our own project?

21.3. Faith as the Preservation of Orientation

From this perspective, faith proves to be not merely the acceptance of a set of dogmas but the capacity to preserve one's orientation toward the supreme Foundation amid a multitude of derivative foundations.

Dogmatic content is indispensable for discernment, yet its formal confession does not by itself guarantee actual orientation.

A person may confess the supreme Foundation while practically absolutizing an institution, a group, or his own role.

Faith therefore possesses a navigational dimension: it continually relates every concrete act of fidelity to its ultimate addressee.

22. The Practice of the Cross

22.1. The Cross as the Refusal of Self-Absolutization

From the Christian perspective, the Cross provides the fullest expression of ontological readdressing.

Here the Cross is understood not only as the event of salvation but also as the structure by which the subject refuses to make his own preservation, success, or historical victory the supreme foundation.

The practice of the Cross means a willingness to allow truth to falsify one's present configuration, to renounce possession of the Other, to refrain from turning a gift into a privilege, and to accept the limits of one's own project.

This is neither a cult of defeat nor a rejection of action.

On the contrary, only a project capable of surviving the renunciation of its own absoluteness can remain open to the Foundation.

22.2. Why Intellect Is Not Enough

The intellect is capable of distinguishing between derivative foundations and the supreme Foundation, but it does not guarantee that a person will renounce a profitable absolutization.

The will is capable of sustaining a decision, yet it may only reinforce a false foundation more firmly.

Education expands one's repertoire of tools, but it does not determine the ultimate addressee of one's fidelity.

The practice of the Cross concerns the entire configuration of existence.

It includes acknowledging one's own finitude, refusing to justify the means by the greatness of the end, the ability to relinquish historical advantage for the sake of truth, and the willingness to undergo refoundation.

22.3. The Criterion of Discernment

The practical criterion may be formulated as follows:

Is an ontology capable of accepting its own historical defeat without betraying the Foundation, or does it alter its very understanding of truth for the sake of self-preservation?

Where the preservation of the project becomes more important than its orientation, the gravity of onticity has already prevailed.

23. Maintaining the Connection with the Foundation

23.1. Subjecthood as Continuous Mobilization

The final stage is not a state of definitive completion.

Maintaining the connection with the Foundation is a continually renewed process of perception, discernment, response, verification, and correction.

Accordingly, mature subjecthood does not rest in the possession of truth but mobilizes the whole of human existence with reference to the Foundation.

This mobilization includes ontic fidelity to facts, biographical responsibility, the capacity for communication, ontological competence, historical projectuality, and eschatological discernment.

None of these levels may be omitted.

Orientation without ontic action remains a declaration.

Action without orientation becomes blind force.

23.2. The Reverse Movement through the Entire Architecture

The connection with the Foundation verifies and transforms every preceding stage.

It deepens the acceptance of reality, because reality is no longer regarded merely as material for desire.

It reinterprets one's own beginning as both gift and task.

It refines responsibility.

It restores the Other as a subject.

It expands the space of possible models.

It limits projectuality while simultaneously liberating it from the fear of historical defeat.

Thus the final stage returns us to the first.

The acceptance of reality was the initial openness to falsification;

maintaining the Foundation becomes the most fully developed form of that openness.

24. Regressions, Ruptures, and the Repetition of the Stages

24.1. The Architecture Does Not Develop Automatically

Any attained level may be lost.

Fear can destroy the acceptance of reality.

Trauma can shatter biographical integration.

Mass mobilization can suppress one's own voice.

Historical success can intensify the gravity of onticity.

Institutionalization can shield the original breakthrough from verification.

Subjecthood therefore requires continual renewal.

Every new situation, in a certain sense, requires one to accept reality anew, to choose one's hermeneutic, and to respond once again.

24.2. Uneven Development

A person may possess strong ontic responsibility but weak ontological competence;

a profound vision of foundations but little capacity for everyday action;

great projectuality combined with a derivative axiology.

A collective may possess its own historical memory while borrowing its image of the future.

Such unevenness is not exceptional;

it constitutes the ordinary ontological profile of the subject.

For this reason, subjecthood cannot be judged by any single conspicuous characteristic—activity, intellect, self-sacrifice, success, or religious rhetoric.

24.3. Refoundation

When the falsity of a foundation is disclosed, it is not enough merely to replace an isolated opinion.

What is required is refoundation: a revision of the entire system of distinctions, the hierarchy of values, the interpretation of the past, and the image of the future.

Refoundation repeats many stages of the architecture at a deeper level:

reality is accepted anew;

the previous hermeneutic is acknowledged as limited;

responsibility is expanded;
identity is reconstituted;
and the project undergoes renewed verification.
Refoundation does not destroy one's previous history.
Rather, it distinguishes within that history what has been authentically appropriated, what is derivative, and what is false, while preserving the continuity of responsibility.

25. Individual and Collective Subjecthood

25.1. Structural Similarity

The stages described above apply both to the individual and to the collective, though not mechanically.

A collective accepts its own beginning through shared memory;
chooses its hermeneutic through education, culture, and public language;
accepts responsibility through procedures of decision-making;
achieves identity through the preservation of a recognizable historical trajectory;
enters into communication through representatives and institutions;
and realizes its project through distributed action.

25.2. The Collective Cannot Replace the Person

Collective subjecthood does not release the individual from personal subjecthood.

The formula "the people decided" does not remove responsibility from those who participate, nor does a common project transform the Other into a legitimate resource.

Conversely, individual morality cannot replace collective procedures.

Without institutional embodiment, a common decision remains merely an aspiration.

25.3. The Condition of Collective Authorship

A collective is a subject to the extent that it is capable of generating and verifying its own axiological, hermeneutical, and projectual logic.

Vitality indicates whether its ontology possesses the power to reproduce itself and to act.

Subjecthood indicates whether the action being carried out is genuinely its own. Vitality determines an ontology's capacity to enter history. Subjecthood determines its capacity to enter history not as the vehicle of someone else's projectuality, but as the source of its own.

Conclusion

The architecture of subjecthood in CTM begins with an elementary yet demanding openness: the acknowledgment of reality as something that is not produced by human desire and is capable of falsifying it.

The acceptance of reality leads to the acceptance of one's own beginning.

The received beginning calls for interpretation; interpretation calls for responsibility; responsibility calls for the acceptance of oneself and the preservation of identity through change.

Thus ontic subjecthood is formed—the capacity to act in one's own name within the concrete reality of life.

Communication reveals the limits of isolated individuality and leads to the question of foundations.

An ontological breakthrough opens the dimension of foundations, yet it does not by itself guarantee correct navigation.

For this reason, the breakthrough must be followed by the development of ontological competence, ontological communication, and the continual verification of one's own model through reality and through the Other.

On the collective level, communication may give rise to the act of society.

A new foundation then undergoes crystallization, reshaping language, memory, values, practices, and the image of the future.

When a subject relates its existence to a historical task, messianic identity emerges.

It increases the power of action, but it does not determine the truth of its direction.

The decisive turning point appears in the encounter with the gravity of onticity.

Derivative foundations are indispensable for historical action, yet they are capable of demanding ultimate fidelity.

At this point it becomes especially important to distinguish ontological competence from socio-ontic projectuality.

The former determines the quality of navigation within the space of foundations; the latter determines the capacity to create and realize a historical project.

Their union increases historical effectiveness, but the correctness of their direction depends upon their orientation toward the Foundation.

Eschatological subjecthood neither abolishes historical subjecthood nor replaces concrete project formation with a ready-made plan of history.

Rather, it preserves the openness of the space of possible models, readdresses ultimate fidelity to the supreme Foundation, and prevents any particular historical form from declaring itself the final fulfillment.

From the Christian perspective, the inner mechanism of such readdressing is found in the Practice of the Cross—the continually repeated refusal of the subject, the institution, and the project to absolutize themselves.

The entire sequence may be summarized by the following formula:

reality addresses the human person → the person accepts existence and his own beginning → interprets what has been received and accepts responsibility → attains identity and acts as an ontic subject → encounters the Other and discovers the dimension of foundations → learns ontological navigation and ontological communication → forms a shared historical project → tests it against the gravity of onticity and the limits of history → readdresses ultimate fidelity to the Foundation → re-enters onticity through concrete, responsible, and ontologically verifiable action.

Subjecthood, therefore, is neither autonomy from every given condition nor possession of a final picture of reality.

It is an architecture of response, in which every increase of power is accompanied by a corresponding increase of responsibility, and in which every act of historical creativity remains open to reality, to the Other, and to the Foundation.

Eschatological Subjecthood

The concept of eschatological subjecthood makes it possible to unite all the preceding stages of the investigation of subjecthood within a single architecture.

The preceding analysis has shown that subjecthood arises not from autonomous self-positing but from the acceptance of reality, the encounter with the Foundation, and the responsive entry into ontological communication.

Eschatological subjecthood receives the horizon of fullness disclosed in relation to the Foundation as a source of normativity and, in accordance with it, unfolds the space of possible models of human and communal existence.

Historical subjecthood selects and concretizes one of these models.

Socio-ontic projectuality creates the institutional architecture for its realization.

Ontic subjecthood embodies the project within reality, where it encounters resistance, entropy, and deformation.

Historical projectuality, however, is not the ultimate meaning of subjecthood.

Its ultimate foundation is disclosed in Christian eschatology: the subject exists because the concrete human person is called to eternal life with God and in God.

Accordingly, history, in its deepest orientation, may be understood as the process of the emergence of ontological communication; the Church as its historical and eschatological beginning; and the eschaton as its final, irreversible, and completely unbounded fullness.

Thus eschatological subjecthood proves to be the entelechy of the entire process of becoming a subject, rather than a final stage externally added to its preceding forms.

Even the earliest forms of subjecthood are inwardly directed toward the fullness of ontological communication with God.

Introduction. Two Questions Concerning One Subject

Every theory of subjecthood inevitably encounters two ultimate questions.

The first is directed toward the future of history:

Why is the human person capable of projecting what does not yet exist?

The second concerns the ultimate meaning of the human person himself:

Why does the subject exist, and why should the concrete human person preserve his identity?

Ordinarily these questions belong to different disciplines.

As a result, the human capacity to disclose what is historically possible and the person's vocation to eternal life are treated separately.

A gap emerges between the projection of the future and the ultimate destiny of the person.

CTM proposes to consider these two questions as two dimensions of a single architecture.

The human person is capable of disclosing the future because his existence is not enclosed within what is presently given.

He is capable of relating reality to the supreme Foundation, of receiving a fullness that has not yet been realized as a source of normativity, and of transforming what is disclosed as possible into an object of historical choice.

Yet this capacity is not an accidental adaptation of the human psyche.

It expresses the deeper vocation of the person:
the subject exists as a mode of responsive being, open to ontological communication with God.

His historical projectuality is the temporal unfolding of that very capacity for response and communion which, in the eschaton, is destined to attain its fullness.

Accordingly, eschatological subjecthood possesses two inseparable orientations.

Within history it discloses and normatively structures the space of possible forms of human existence.

From the perspective of humanity's ultimate vocation it reveals why subjecthood itself possesses enduring significance.

Eschatology thus becomes simultaneously the source of historical openness and the ultimate foundation of human subjecthood.

1. From the End of History to the Eschatological Dimension of Subjecthood

Traditional Christian eschatology speaks of the last things: the resurrection of the dead, the Last Judgment, the transformation of creation, the Kingdom of God, and the final destiny of the human person.

This content cannot be discarded or replaced.

Yet reducing it to the chronologically final chapter of dogmatics conceals the philosophical significance of the eschatological.

Eschatology concerns not only how history will end but also the capacity to perceive the present in the light of a fullness that has not yet been realized.

The human person does not live only within what is presently given.

Education, family, science, culture, economics, politics, and civilization are possible because the subject acts in the present in relation to what does not yet exist.

The future is first present as an image of the possible; it then becomes a goal, a project, and an organizing principle of action.

Yet this elementary orientation toward the future is not yet eschatological subjecthood.

Planning may remain merely technical, adaptive, or entirely enclosed within the existing order.

Eschatological subjecthood emerges where what is presently given is related to the ultimate horizon of being.

It holds together two affirmations:

what exists is real and must be accepted;

what exists does not exhaust the possible forms of human existence.

Accordingly, it does not deny the present but deprives it of any claim to finality.

Its primary definition may therefore be formulated as follows:

Eschatological subjecthood is the capacity to keep reality open to the possibility of its transformation.

This understanding must be distinguished from futurology, forecasting, apocalyptic speculation, and secular utopianism.

Futurology extrapolates observable trends.

Forecasting calculates what is probable.

Utopianism constructs what is desired, often at the cost of denying reality.

Eschatological subjecthood, by contrast, proceeds from reality that has been accepted, yet considers it in relation to the Foundation that transcends the present order.

It discloses not merely what is probable, nor simply what is arbitrarily desired, but what is possible and what ought to be in the light of ultimate fullness.

2. Subjecthood as Response: Reality, the Foundation, and the Logos

Eschatological subjecthood does not arise in an already constituted autonomous subject.

CTM takes seriously the critique of the classical model of the self-sufficient "I."

The human person is conditioned by the body, language, origin, the unconscious, social relations, history, power, and culture.

Yet the death of the autonomous subject does not entail the death of subjecthood.

Subjecthood begins with the capacity to acknowledge one's own conditionedness and, despite it, to accept reality as it is and then to establish a responsible relationship to it.

Its ascending movement proceeds through the acceptance of reality, the acceptance of one's own beginning, the choice of the hermeneutic of one's beginning, the hermeneutic of responsibility, the acceptance of oneself, and the attainment of identity with oneself.

The subject does not choose his body, family, language, people, historical epoch, or original history, yet he is capable of choosing how to understand the beginning he has received and the direction of his further existence.

Acceptance does not mean justifying everything that has been given.

It means refusing to replace reality with a compensatory identity and accepting responsibility for one's response.

Yet the subject's ascent from onticity toward the Foundation constitutes only one aspect of the event.

The subject does not produce the Foundation out of his own experience.

He is preceded by an address: an encounter with the Logos, the reception of the gift, and the necessity of responding.

Subjecthood arises in the meeting of these two movements—the movement of the human person from onticity toward the Foundation, and the address of the Foundation to the human person, through which his being within onticity is transformed.

What is primary, therefore, is not an act of independent self-positing, but a response to an address.

The subject is born as a participant in communication who seeks to make communicable what has been disclosed to him.

The formula *Communico ergo homo* expresses not merely humanity's social character but the ontological structure of human existence:

the human person becomes a subject to the extent that he is capable of responding, recognizing the other as a participant in being, and entering into communication concerning the foundations of existence.

Within this perspective it is necessary to distinguish between the Foundation, derivative foundations, and foundationing.

The Foundation is the ultimate center of ontological orientation; within the Christian structure of CTM it possesses a Logos-centered and Christological meaning.

The state, the nation, class, the market, security, power, technology, culture, and individual well-being are derivative foundations.

They may be necessary and historically significant, yet they become destructive when they usurp the function of the ultimate.

Foundationing denotes not a static support but an act of the subject.

Foundationing toward reality expresses the navigational character of this act:

the subject neither creates reality ex nihilo nor declares his own interpretation to be reality, but directs himself toward reality and orders his existence according to what he acknowledges as its Foundation.

Faith may therefore be defined as the capacity to maintain orientation toward the supreme Foundation amid a multiplicity of derivative foundations.

The subject's ascent from onticity toward the Foundation, however, may be slowed, and in the extreme case even halted, by the gravity of onticity.

Within CTM, the gravity of onticity denotes an epistemological aberration whereby the subject mistakes a derivative foundation for the ultimate one and ceases further ontological navigation.

The nation, the state, progress, liberation, security, or social justice may all be genuine and necessary foundations for historical action.

Yet the gravity of onticity causes the subject to lose sight of their derivative character and to treat one of them as the final horizon of being.

Having fallen under this gravity, the subject retains the capacity for historical projectuality but loses the ultimate horizon—and with it the possibility of eschatological subjecthood.

3. The Horizon of Fullness and the Origin of Normativity

The encounter with the Foundation does not provide the subject with a ready-made political program, economic system, or institutional blueprint.

Rather, it opens a horizon of fullness, in relation to which the present becomes discernible in its truth, incompleteness, and brokenness.

The eschatological horizon answers the question:

Toward what fullness is being directed?

From this arises normativity.

Normativity is neither an arbitrary code imposed upon a neutral reality nor something derived directly from interest, power, or historical necessity.

The horizons of eschatology give rise to the horizons of normativity because only an image of fullness enables one to discern what ought to be preserved, transformed, created, or rejected.

Eschatology discloses the ultimate measure;

normativity translates that measure into the coordinates of the present.

This does not mean that every concrete norm can be deduced directly from the eschatological horizon.

Between fullness and historical decision there remains a space for understanding, freedom, and responsibility.

Without reference to fullness, however, normativity loses its ultimate foundation and becomes either a mere preservation of the existing order, an

expression of prevailing power, or a convention incapable of answering why it ought to be preserved once interests change.

Eschatological subjecthood therefore does more than merely expand the range of conceivable alternatives.

It normatively structures the possible.

Within the opened space it distinguishes what is worthy of realization, what is permissible, what is neutral, what is destructive, what is anthropologically impossible, and what is technically possible yet ontologically impermissible.

The possible is not identical with the normative.

Yet the normative cannot be recognized without the prior disclosure of the possible.

Eschatological subjecthood unites these dimensions without confusing them.

4. The Variability of Metaphysics and the Space of Possible Worlds

The historically significant function proper to eschatological subjecthood is the expansion of the variability of metaphysics.

Here metaphysics denotes not merely a philosophical doctrine but an architecture of possible human existence.

Every metaphysical model determines what is recognized as real, who the human person is, wherein freedom and dignity consist, who the other is, what the limits of power are, what time means, why society exists, and what kind of future is worthy of realization.

The variability of metaphysics denotes the capacity to generate and distinguish alternative architectures of being.

The space of possible metaphysical models is the result of this capacity.

Eschatological subjecthood does not simply select one ready-made system from an already existing collection.

Its deeper function is to make thinkable forms of humanity and communal life that cannot be derived from the prevailing order.

Orientation toward the Foundation liberates the subject from absolute dependence upon the present.

It makes it possible to affirm that the human person is not exhausted by a social function; that power is not the source of ultimate normativity; that the strong are not necessarily right; that the other is not a mere means; that death does not possess the final word; and that history is not closed within the perpetual reproduction of violence.

Each of these affirmations expresses more than a conviction.

It opens a new metaphysical possibility, thereby expanding the scope of historical freedom.

However, variability does not imply relativism.

Models are evaluated according to their fidelity to reality, their relation to the Foundation, their anthropological adequacy, their relation to the Other, their logical coherence, the resources available for their realization, and the consequences of their embodiment.

A broad scope combined with low resolving power gives rise to utopianism.

High resolving power combined with a narrow scope produces technocratic pragmatism, capable of correcting details yet incapable of asking about the direction of history.

Mature eschatological subjecthood unites the broadest possible scope with attentiveness to the concrete human cost of every project.

Thus its meta-projectual function becomes clear.

Eschatological subjecthood does not design concrete history.

Rather, it forms and expands the space of possible metaphysical models, within which historical subjecthood selects and concretizes a historical project.

5. Historical Subjecthood, Vocation, and the Freedom of Choice

The transition from open possibility to historical action requires a subject capable of accepting vocation and responsibility.

Within the Christian perspective, CTM designates the subject's acceptance of this transition as messianic identity: the human person understands himself in relation to the Logos, who has disclosed the possible to him, and accepts responsibility for participating in the transformation of the world.

Within the context of CTM, messianic identity does not mean appropriating to oneself the role of the Savior.

Rather, it is the recognition that the address is directed to me and calls for my response.

Messianic identity is not a distinct universal level of every form of historical projectuality.

It is a particular mode of the historical subject's self-understanding, in which the subject perceives himself as the bearer of a vocation to transform or redeem history.

Messianic identity may be oriented either toward the supreme Foundation or toward an absolutized derivative foundation—class, nation, state, race, civilization, or the idea of progress.

Accordingly, it may assume Christian, religious, national, revolutionary, or other ideological forms.

Not every form of historical subjecthood is therefore messianic.

A subject may possess considerable projectual power without interpreting his activity as a unique vocation.

Conversely, the acceptance of messianic identity does not by itself guarantee the ability to create major historical forms.

Historical subjecthood operates within the space opened and normatively structured by eschatological subjecthood.

It discerns the situation, evaluates available resources, perceives alternatives, selects a model, concretizes it, formulates goals, creates a historical project, and mobilizes the collective subject.

If eschatological subjecthood answers the question, "What forms of human existence are possible and worthy of realization?", historical subjecthood answers, "What kind of world should—and can—be built here and now?"

A single orientation toward the Foundation may allow for several historical concretizations.

Historical subjecthood therefore cannot justify its own choices simply by appealing directly to the Foundation.

Between the eschatological horizon and every political, economic, or cultural form there always remain human understanding, risk, and responsibility.

The hermeneutic of responsibility requires us to distinguish between what is disclosed by the Foundation, our own interpretation of it, the concrete project itself, and its unforeseen consequences.

Historical freedom arises not from the absence of constraints but from the existence of meaningful alternatives.

If only one form of the world is conceivable, history is reduced to adaptation and the reproduction of what already exists.

Eschatological subjecthood liberates history by disclosing alternatives.

Historical subjecthood realizes that freedom by making a decision and accepting responsibility for it.

6. Socio-Ontic Projectuality and the Entry of the Model into Reality

Between the historical project and its ontic realization stands socio-ontic projectuality.

Historical subjecthood determines what kind of world ought to be built.

Socio-ontic projectuality creates the architecture through which that world can be realized.

It translates the general project into the language of the state, law, economics, education, governance, the military, culture, memory, communication, and the distribution of resources.

Ontic subjecthood performs concrete actions within this architecture.

It builds, governs, teaches, produces, distributes, protects, and communicates.

It is not the residual or lowest level of the system.

It is precisely here that the decisive question is answered: Will the metaphysical possibility enter actual human life, or will it remain merely a declaration?

The movement from the Foundation to history therefore comprises several irreducible functions.

In response to the Foundation's address, eschatological subjecthood opens the horizon of fullness.

From this arises the normative structuring of the possible.

The variability of metaphysics generates the space of possible models.

Historical subjecthood selects and concretizes one of them.

Socio-ontic projectuality creates the institutional architecture.

Ontic subjecthood embodies it in practice.

The Foundation enters onticity neither as one thing among other things, nor as an external mechanical cause, nor as a ready-made political program.

It enters through the architecture of response, communication, project formation, and embodiment.

The Foundation is the source of the horizon, but not the immediate author of human constructions.

Every concrete historical form belongs to human choice and therefore remains limited, corrigible, and accountable.

The Christological archetype of this structure is ὁ Λόγος σὰρξ ἐγένετο—"the Logos became flesh."

In Christ, the Logos enters onticity directly and hypostatically.

In human history, however, the possibility disclosed by the Logos enters onticity indirectly—through subjecthood, ontological communication, project, and action.

Accordingly, the formula "The Foundation entered onticity through subjecthood" does not confuse the Incarnation of the Logos with human history.

Rather, it identifies the derivative architecture of the historical response.

7. The Entropy of Historical Embodiment and the Testing of the Project by History

Onticity is not merely passive material for a project.

Existing institutions strive for self-reproduction.

Resources are limited.

Social groups defend their own interests.

Bureaucracy replaces the original goal with the preservation of the mechanism itself.

Language is devalued.

The original motivation weakens.

Means acquire an independent authority of their own.

The totality of these processes, through which a historical project gradually loses its original ontological density in the course of its realization, may be called entropy.

Entropy is not limited to external resistance against the realization of a project.

It also operates within the project itself, gradually weakening its connection with its original metaphysical model and with the Foundation.

At the same time, the distortions that arise reveal deficiencies in the project's scope, resolving power, and foundationing.

A project may prove to be abstract, anthropologically inadequate, or covertly oriented toward a derivative foundation.

Real history therefore tests not only the quality of execution but also the institutional architecture, the historical choice, the metaphysical model, and the ultimate orientation of subjecthood itself.

8. Pathologies of Eschatological and Historical Projectuality

The greatest danger lies in replacing eschatological openness with a closed historical eschaton.

Social eschatology, in its positive sense, discloses possible forms of communal existence in the light of the ultimate horizon.

Socio-eschatological projectuality, in its pathological sense, attempts to achieve final fullness through history itself and declares a particular social order to be the fulfillment of human existence.

Communism, National Socialism, and other closed ideologies differ in content but share the same structure.

A derivative foundation—class, race, nation, state, the market, or technology—is absolutized.

A concrete project is proclaimed final.

A historical form is sacralized.

The space for criticism and refoundation is closed.

Here, high mobilizational capacity and socio-ontic projectuality are combined with low ontological competence.

Historical subjecthood must therefore be evaluated along at least two independent axes.

The first is ontological competence: the capacity to discover and distinguish foundations without mistaking the derivative for the absolute.

The second is socio-ontic projectuality: the capacity to translate vision into a collective project, to create institutions, and to change the course of history.

High competence without projectuality may remain historically barren.

High projectuality without competence may produce catastrophe.

Their union constitutes onto-projectual subjecthood, whose Christian form is messianic subjecthood.

9. Other Pathologies of Eschatological and Historical Projectuality

Other pathologies include utopianism, understood as project formation without the acceptance of reality; apocalyptic paralysis, which destroys responsibility through the expectation of the end; messianic narcissism, whereby the subject appropriates ultimate truth to itself; eschatological inflation, in which every event is proclaimed ultimate; and metaphysical closure, in which the expansion of the space of the possible comes to an end.

The common characteristic of all these distortions is the identification of the Foundation with the subject, with the subject's own interpretation, or with a historical project.

10. Ontological Communication and the Collective Subject

An open possibility does not become a historical force until it becomes communicable.

Ontic communication transmits information, directives, emotions, and practical content.

Ontological communication concerns the conditions of shared existence: what is recognized as real, what is acknowledged as the Foundation, who people recognize one another to be, and which forms of common history they regard as possible and worthy of realization.

The eschatological subject must not compel others to accept a ready-made model.

Its function is to introduce a new possibility into the shared space of understanding, critique, and responsibility.

A vision that is, in principle, incapable of becoming the object of ontological communication either remains a private experience or degenerates into a closed ideology.

A society becomes a collective eschatological subject when it is capable of discussing the foundations of its own existence, generating alternative models of the future, distinguishing ultimate and derivative foundations, critically re-examining its own foundationing, and assuming responsibility for its historical choices.

This requires a language of ontological communication, institutions of memory, education, spaces for free discussion, traditions of self-criticism, the transmission of competencies, and an ontological intelligentsia.

Within CTM, the historical condition of a society in which such communication is possible, effective, and participates in shaping the future is called living time.

A condition in which ontological communication is blocked, ritualized, or deprived of the capacity to influence a society's foundationing and historical choices is called dead time.

Two societies may both exist in the same calendar year—for example, 2026.

One may inhabit living time, while the other remains in dead time.

They may be neighbors, interact continuously, and belong to the same historical epoch, while remaining ontologically non-synchronous.

They exist in different modes of historical time, and the trajectories of their development may never converge.

Living time is the time in which a society remains capable of re-examining its foundations and projecting its future.

Dead time is the time in which existing reality is merely reproduced after the loss of the capacity for ontological choice.

A society may possess military, administrative, or economic power while remaining ontologically non-subjective.

It may efficiently carry out another subject's project, react to external challenges, or reproduce inherited forms without being able to ask why it exists or in what direction it ought to move.

Collective subjecthood therefore begins not with power as such, but with the shared capacity to perceive reality, formulate purposes, and assume responsibility for a chosen model of the future.

11. The Church as the Beginning of Eschatological Communication

Within this architecture, the interconnected functions of the Church become apparent.

The Church preserves orientation toward the supreme Foundation, safeguards the memory of the encounter with the Logos, regenerates the ontological density of communication, forms eschatological subjecthood, and makes *μετάνοια* possible as an act of refoundation.

The Church may therefore be defined as the infrastructure of ontological re-addressing: the space in which the subject becomes capable of recognizing the absolutization of a derivative foundation, restoring orientation toward the supreme Foundation, and thereby forming a personal eschatology—a vision of one's own ultimate becoming and of the fullness of life with God and in God.

Yet this function possesses not only a restorative but also a creative dimension.

The Church is called not merely to preserve established formulations or reproduce earlier historical forms.

Its proclamation, liturgy, ascetic practice, witness, and life are meant to disclose models of the human person and of communion that cannot arise within the limits of closed immanence.

The Church is not required to develop every political or economic program.

It is required to preserve and expand the metaphysical horizon within which historical subjecthood can create projects without absolutizing the state, the nation, the market, ideology, or technology.

The crisis of Christianity begins when the direction of ontological influence is reversed.

Instead of movement from the Foundation, through the Church's eschatological subjecthood, into the space of metaphysical possibilities and then into history, the opposite movement takes place: society generates its own metaphysics, while the Church adapts Christian language to them and legitimizes the existing order.

The Foundation continues to be confessed dogmatically, yet ceases to enter onticity.

Christian language remains, but no longer opens new forms of being.

The Church, however, is not merely a historical institution for the production and regeneration of subjecthood.

If the ultimate destiny of the human person is life with God and in God, then ecclesial life already constitutes the beginning of that ontological communication which, in the eschaton, is to attain its fullness.

The eschaton therefore does not merely follow history.

It already begins within history itself as the real, though not yet complete, communion between God and the human person.

12. The Final Question of Subjecthood

The historical architecture of projectuality still does not answer the question of why the subject exists at all.

If history ends with the disappearance of the person, subjecthood remains nothing more than a temporary function of evolution, a mechanism of adaptation, or a brief episode in the self-organization of matter.

It may be extraordinarily complex and historically productive, yet its ultimate meaning disappears together with the subject itself.

Christian eschatology affirms the opposite.

The concrete human person is not dissolved into the Absolute, does not give way to an impersonal cosmic necessity, and does not vanish once its historical function has been fulfilled.

What endures is not human nature in general, nor the idea of humanity, nor merely the memory of a person.

It is precisely this person, together with his or her unique history and identity.

From this, subjecthood receives its eschatological foundation.

It is not merely an anthropological characteristic or a capacity for making history.

It is a mode of personal existence corresponding to humanity's ultimate vocation.

The subject exists because he is called to eternal life with God and in God.

Everything that appears in history as the acceptance of reality, response, responsibility, identity, freedom, and communication acquires ultimate significance because the person is not destined for disappearance.

This does not mean that subjecthood automatically guarantees salvation, nor that eternal life is derived from human capability.

On the contrary, eternity is God's gift.

Yet it is precisely the vocation to receive that gift that explains why the subject must become capable of response, of preserving identity, and of entering into free communication.

Subjecthood thus proves to be the anthropological form of the person's readiness for a relationship that transcends history.

13. The Absoluteness of God and the Absolute Significance of the Human Person

The Christian affirmation of the eternity of the concrete human person creates a tension between the finitude of the person and the absoluteness of God.

CTM does not resolve this tension by transforming the human person into the Absolute.

Absoluteness belongs to God alone.

The human person remains created, finite, and ontologically dependent.

Yet the absoluteness of God does not diminish the human person.

On the contrary, it is precisely the absolutely perfect and free God who is capable of bestowing eternal and irreversible significance upon a finite being without diminishing His own absoluteness.

The human person does not become absolute in being; rather, his or her significance becomes absolute for God.

The person is therefore not subject to replacement, dissolution, or reduction to a means for an impersonal whole.

Thus the false alternative between humanism and theocentrism is overcome.

The human person is neither the center of being nor the measure of God, yet God does not require the destruction of human uniqueness.

Instead, personal theocentrism emerges: God creates the cosmos for the sake of the human person, and the human person for communion with Himself.

The ultimate purpose of creation is therefore neither the cosmos as such nor the autonomous individual, but the free life of the concrete human person with God and in God.

The human person is exalted not by occupying the place of the Absolute, but by becoming God's eternal interlocutor.

For this reason, the dignity of the person possesses not merely a moral or juridical foundation but an eschatological one.

The other can never be reduced to a function, a resource, a bearer of identity, or material for a historical project, because every person is called to eternal communion with God.

14. The Trinitarian and Christological Foundation of Eschatological Communication

Christian eschatology differs from a merely general belief in the postmortem survival of the person because its Foundation is neither an impersonal Absolute nor a supreme being enclosed within itself, but the Triune God.

The Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit exist not as three isolated centers but in eternal hypostatic communion.

The divine hypostases are distinguished by their eternal relations of origin, while the unity of God does not abolish their distinction.

Consequently, relation and communion do not arise merely within the created world, nor are they external additions to being.

In Christian revelation, the supreme Foundation is disclosed as the Trinitarian fullness of hypostatic being and communion.

Yet the Triune God does not remain beyond onticity.

In the Incarnation, the Logos not only communicates knowledge of the Foundation or opens the horizon of the possible.

He Himself enters created reality, assuming human nature, a human body, and human history.

Accordingly, the relation between the Foundation and onticity possesses not only a projectual architecture but, above all, a Christological foundation.

The possibility of humanity's movement toward God rests upon God's prior movement toward humanity.

This entrance into onticity was not the detached presence of an external observer.

One of the Holy Trinity suffered in the flesh.

The incarnate Logos assumed the ontic vulnerability of human existence, suffering, and death, paying the price for the restoration of communion between God and humanity.

At the same time, the divine nature neither suffered nor underwent change.

The subject of suffering was the Son of God, who suffered according to the human nature He had assumed.

Christian eschatology therefore rests not upon an abstract promise of future fullness but upon the accomplished events of the Incarnation, the Cross, and the Resurrection.

The Cross discloses yet another fundamental foundation of Christian subjecthood.

In Christ, God acknowledged the ontological seriousness of human subjecthood to such an extent that He allowed humanity to place Him under judgment.

He neither annulled the human verdict through coercion nor destroyed those who judged Him, but freely accepted its ontic consequences, even unto death.

God acknowledged not the correctness of humanity's judgment upon Him, but the reality of human freedom and the capacity of the human response to become a historical event with genuine consequences.

Thus the Cross reveals the fullness of responsibility—not as the confession of guilt by the innocent, but as the willingness to bear the cost of relationship without destroying the freedom of the Other.

The Resurrection of Christ demonstrates that although human judgment produced real ontic consequences, it did not acquire the authority to determine the ultimate truth about Christ.

The entrance of the Foundation into onticity does not conclude with God being absorbed by history or with death achieving final victory over human nature.

On the contrary, the human nature assumed by the Logos enters a new mode of existence in which death is no longer the ultimate limit.

The Resurrection therefore constitutes not merely the confirmation of the truth of the Christian proclamation but the ontological beginning of the human eschaton.

Eternal ontological communication with God becomes possible not because the finite subject reaches the Absolute by its own powers, but because the Triune God Himself has opened participation in His own life to humanity.

The eschaton is therefore not an endless continuation of humanity's relation to an external Foundation, but the entrance of the human person, through Christ, into the life of the Trinity—while preserving the distinction between Creator and creation, the uniqueness of the person, and the integrity of the resurrected human being.

The distinctiveness of Christian eschatology is therefore determined by the unity of three affirmations:

- the supreme Foundation is the Triune God;
- the Triune God entered onticity in the Person of the Son;
- the incarnate Logos suffered in the flesh and rose again, opening to humanity the possibility of eternal life with God and in God.

The human vocation to eternal ontological communication therefore rests not upon an abstract metaphysical possibility but upon the Trinitarian life of God and the accomplished event of Christ, in whom God not only entered human history but also accepted, to the very end, the consequences of humanity's free response.

15. The Eschaton as the Fullness of Ontological Communication

The eschaton cannot be reduced to communication alone.

It includes the resurrection of the body, the transfiguration of creation, the Kingdom of God, deification, and the final triumph of life.

Yet these realities receive their inner unity in the definitive relationship between God and the human person.

The eschaton may therefore be defined as that state of being in which ontological communication between God and the human person becomes definitive, irreversible, and no longer subject to any limitation.

This is why the person endures: communion presupposes not dissolution but the continuing identity of those who participate in it.

This is why the body is raised: the human being enters fullness not as a disembodied consciousness but in the integrity of created existence.

This is why the cosmos is transfigured: creation becomes not a temporary stage destined for disappearance but the space of definitive communion.

Eternal ontological communication does not consist in an endless exchange of information.

It signifies the fullness of participation in being while preserving the distinction between Creator and creation. God remains God, and the human person remains human. Union does not abolish personhood; rather, it brings subjecthood to its fullness. Definitive openness to God does not abolish freedom, because freedom is here liberated from falsehood, corruption, fear, and death, attaining complete conformity with its own vocation.

Thus the profound unity of the historical and ultimate dimensions of eschatological subjecthood becomes evident. Within history, the subject keeps the present open to the possible, receives the horizon of fullness as the source of normativity, enters into communication, and chooses and embodies projects. In the eschaton, that openness reaches its consummation: the possible becomes fullness; normative orientation becomes realized being; and communication becomes irreversible communion with the Foundation.

16. The Completed Architecture of CTM

The complete logic begins neither with an abstract subject nor ends with a historical project.

Its originating event is the address of the Foundation, received by the human person within reality.

Its historical content is the formation and embodiment of possible forms of being.

Its ultimate meaning is eternal ontological communication.

This architecture may be expressed as the following sequence:

the address of the Foundation → the acceptance of reality and one's own beginning → response → subjecthood → ontological communication → the eschatological horizon of fullness → the horizon of normativity → the variability of metaphysics and the space of possible models → historical choice → historical project → socio-ontic architecture → ontic embodiment → the entropy and deformation of the project → reflection and refoundation → the renewal of communion with the Foundation → the fullness of ontological communication in the eschaton.

This sequence should not be understood as a simple chronology.

Ontological communication is present at every level.

The subject is born in response.

The possible becomes historically effective through communication.

A collective project is formed within a shared space of understanding.

The Church regenerates communication.

The eschaton reveals its ultimate fulfillment.

Likewise, the eschatological horizon does not merely conclude history but acts within history itself as the source of normativity and freedom.

The central formula of CTM may therefore be expressed in two complementary ways.

From the historical perspective:

The Foundation enters onticity through subjecthood.

From the eschatological perspective:

The subject exists because it is called to eternal ontological communication with God.

These two formulations describe the reciprocal movements of a single relationship.

The Foundation addresses the human person and, through the person's free response, enters history.

The human person responds within history and moves toward the fullness of life with the Foundation.

Conclusion

Eschatological subjecthood is not merely another variety of subjecthood, nor can it be reduced to the expectation of the last things.

Rather, it discloses the whole of human subjecthood from the perspective of its ultimate horizon.

The subject comes into being as a response to the address of the Foundation, accepts reality and its own beginning, enters into ontological communication, and thereby acquires the capacity to perceive the present in the light of a fullness not yet realized.

From the horizon of fullness arises normativity.

From normatively structured possibility arises the variability of metaphysics.

From the space of models emerges historical choice.

From choice comes the project.

From the project arise institutional architecture and ontic embodiment.

Reality resists every project, exposes its limitations, and demands reflection and refoundation.

History is therefore not the straightforward realization of a predetermined scenario but the space of a free, responsible, and corrigible response.

Yet history does not exhaust the meaning of subjecthood.

The concrete human person exists not merely as the bearer of a historical function.

He or she is called to eternal life with God and in God.

The absoluteness of God does not abolish the finite person but grants that person eternal and irreversible significance.

Already within history, the Church becomes the beginning of eschatological communication, while the eschaton is revealed as its definitive fulfillment—in the resurrection of the body, the transfiguration of creation, and the preservation of the unique identity of every human person.

Christian eschatology thus proves to be not an external appendix to anthropology but its ultimate foundation.

History is the becoming of ontological communication.

The eschaton is its fullness.

The Foundation enters onticity through subjecthood, and subjecthood attains its meaning in eternal life with the Foundation.

Modernization: The First Practical Application of CTM

The project To Christians of the Third Millennium (CTM) originally emerged as an attempt to develop a philosophical language adequate for modeling a contemporary Christian ecclesiology. As its Christological inquiry developed, however, the research gradually moved far beyond the boundaries of ecclesiology itself. Its focus shifted toward the conditions for the emergence of subjecthood, the structure of the human ontological architecture, the ways in which this architecture relates to reality, the Other, and the Ground, as well as the laws governing its formation, transformation, and disintegration.

As CTM developed, it became increasingly evident that the conceptual framework it had produced possessed a far greater explanatory and generative capacity than had originally been anticipated. Its application to new domains does not merely consist in transferring existing concepts into different contexts. Rather, it leads to the discovery of new objects of inquiry, the formulation of new research questions, and the emergence of autonomous disciplines that nevertheless retain a common methodological foundation.

In its broadest perspective, this line of inquiry leads toward the construction of a General Theory of Ontological Architectures (GTOA). Its subject matter is the origin, structure, historical evolution, interaction, conflict, reconciliation, and transformation of diverse ontological architectures, regardless of the particular sphere in which they are manifested.

The present study constitutes the first practical application of this broader research program. Its immediate subject is a theory of modernization. Its purpose, however, is not merely to propose a new model of modernization processes. It also seeks to demonstrate how the conceptual apparatus of CTM makes it possible to move from a fundamental theory of subjecthood to autonomous disciplines investigating concrete forms of the historical existence of human beings and societies.

Research Motivation

The present study has a relatively long intellectual prehistory. In 2007, the author published a work devoted to the problem of enhancing the political culture of a particular post-colonial society. Even at that stage, a correlation had already been identified between the quality of collective mobilization and the complexity of the narrative capable of sustaining it. The mechanism underlying this relationship, however, remained unclear.

Why does the complexity of a narrative influence a society's capacity for collective action at all?

The conceptual framework available at that time made it possible to analyze primarily political language, historical memory, forms of mobilization, and institutional organization. Gradually, however, it became apparent that these categories described different aspects of the phenomenon without revealing its underlying mechanism.

The Research Question Reconsidered

Over time, the central research question underwent a fundamental transformation. It became clear that the complexity of modern society is determined not so much by the number of institutions, technologies, or the volume of

accumulated knowledge as by the ever-expanding space of increasingly differentiated social functions and the operational roles associated with them. Consequently, the primary question is no longer simply how institutions arise, but how a human being becomes capable of sustaining the growing complexity of the roles through which those institutions operate.

It is precisely at this point that the results of CTM acquired direct methodological significance. If CTM I shifted the center of philosophical analysis toward subjecthood, CTM II proposed a model of the subject's ontological architecture, making it possible to reformulate the original problem on an entirely different level.

The central research question therefore assumes the following form:

How does a subject become capable of sustaining increasingly complex forms of social action, interiorizing the corresponding operational ontologies, and assuming an ever-expanding scope of responsibility?

From Traditional Modernization Theory to the Perspective of Subjecthood

Most existing theories of modernization understand modernization as a historical process involving changes in institutions, technology, the economy, political structures, cultural norms, and mechanisms of social organization. Even when the human person occupies the center of analysis, they are typically understood primarily as a bearer of competencies, a participant in institutional relations, an object of socialization, or the performer of a professional role.

CTM proposes a fundamentally different perspective.

Its primary concern is not merely what institutions a modern society requires, but rather what kind of subject is capable of acting within those institutions without becoming merely an executor of external causality.

The focus of inquiry thus shifts to the correspondence between two distinct processes.

On the one hand, society historically generates increasingly complex social functions, institutional forms, and operational roles.

On the other hand, the human being must become a subject capable of sustaining the complexity of these roles, discerning the ontologies embedded within them, accepting, transforming, or rejecting them, and assuming responsibility for the consequences of their own response.

The character of this correspondence ultimately determines the quality of modernization.

The Single Pre-Reflective Axiom

The entire investigation that follows rests upon a single methodological axiom:

CTM approaches modernization exclusively from the standpoint of the subject's ontological position.

All subsequent distinctions follow directly from this single premise.

Accordingly, the present study is not concerned with processes of discipline, ideological indoctrination, conditioning, colonization, social adaptation, or other forms of external influence as such.

All such processes are capable of modifying human behavior and transmitting knowledge, skills, technologies, and institutional forms. Yet by themselves they cannot produce subjective interiorization, nor can they provide the subject's own response in place of the subject.

They therefore belong to an entirely different class of phenomena.

The present study is concerned exclusively with the subject's relation to ontology: its recognition, verification, acceptance, transformation, reconciliation, or rejection.

From Modernization to the Genealogy of Ontologies

At first glance, such a formulation of the problem might appear to require only a deeper analysis of the subject. The further development of the research, however, led to a different conclusion.

If modernization consists in the reconciliation between the subject's personal ontological architecture and the operational ontologies of particular forms of activity, then it is insufficient to investigate only the conditions of subjective interiorization.

It becomes equally necessary to understand the nature of the ontologies themselves.

How do they arise?

Why do they become historically more complex?

How are they related to one another?

Why do they come into conflict?

And what kind of subject does each require for its realization?

Modernization theory thus leads to a more fundamental research task—the construction of a genealogy of ontologies.

For this reason, the discussion begins not with modernization itself but with a reconstruction of the historical emergence of the various ways in which human beings organize their relationship to reality.

Only then will it become possible to demonstrate how the historical evolution of ontologies encounters the ontogenesis of subjecthood, and why this encounter constitutes the very substance of modernization.

Genealogy of Ontologies

If social conflicts are understood as particular instances of conflicts between ontologies, then it becomes necessary to investigate not only the ontologies that already exist but also their origins.

A simple classification merely describes established forms without explaining why they arise, how they become interconnected, or why their relationships eventually become conflictual.

At first sight, it may seem sufficient to distinguish between the ontology of immediate human relationships, the socio-institutional ontology, and the operational ontologies derived from it for particular forms of activity.

Such a typology, however, remains static.

It tells us nothing about how one mode of human engagement with reality reaches its own limits, nor why those limits generate the necessity for a new mode.

Accordingly, the object of investigation must not be a typology of ontologies but their genealogy.

The genealogy of ontologies is the study of the historical emergence, differentiation, increasing complexity, and interaction of the various ways in which human beings organize their relationship to reality, to the Other, and to responsibility.

Unlike a typology, a genealogy regards each new ontology not as an isolated system but as a response to the limitations of a preceding form of existence.

The history of society may therefore be described not merely as a succession of events and institutions, but as the history of the emergence, branching, and reconciliation of ontologies.

In what follows, a distinction will be made between the First Ontology and the Second Ontology. These designations indicate their place within the genealogy, but they also possess substantive meaning.

The First Ontology is the ontology of immediate responsibility, exercised within the sphere of direct human relationships.

The Second Ontology is the ontology of mediated—or social—responsibility, exercised through social functions, roles, and institutions.

The numbering denotes neither superiority nor a hierarchy of value, but only the sequence of emergence.

The Second Ontology is not "higher" than the First, nor does it abolish it.

Rather, it emerges precisely where the scale of immediate human relationships proves insufficient for sustaining newly arising social tasks.

The First Ontology: The Ontology of Immediate Responsibility

The First Ontology organizes human existence through an immediate relationship with a concrete Other.

Human beings first encounter reality not through institutions, professional roles, or the state. Rather, they discover themselves already embedded within a network of relationships that precedes both reflection and choice.

These include the relationships between parents and children, brothers and sisters, husbands and wives, elders and the young, friends, neighbors, hosts and guests, insiders and outsiders, the living and the dead, and the present generation in relation to those of the past and those yet to come.

Within this ontology, the human person first encounters the Other.

Here arise the primordial experiences of trust and betrayal, love and fear, belonging and alienation, gratitude and obligation, protection, memory, hostility, and mutual responsibility.

The First Ontology is not a historical stage left behind. It remains the foundational level of human existence throughout every form of social complexity.

Institutions do not abolish kinship.

Law does not eliminate friendship.

The state does not replace the family.

A professional role never exhausts one's relationship with a concrete Other.

Yet the First Ontology does not, by itself, produce subjecthood.

It creates the space within which a subjective response becomes possible, but it does not guarantee its emergence.

Immediate relationships may become the space in which the dignity of the Other is recognized.

They may equally reproduce violence, domination, tribal exclusiveness, clan loyalty, and the objectification of the human person.

Belonging to the First Ontology is therefore not, in itself, a sufficient criterion of its quality.

Subjecthood is not inherited through kinship, tradition, or status.

It always requires one's own response and one's own ontological payment.

The Limits of the First Ontology

The First Ontology possesses a high density of human relationships, yet a limited scale. It is capable of organizing responsibility within the sphere of personal acquaintance, direct reciprocity, kinship, neighborhood, and the enduring memory of the community.

As long as everyone knows everyone else, many social tasks can indeed be accomplished through personal trust, the authority of elders, direct loyalty, and mutual responsibility. As society grows and becomes more complex, however, an entirely new class of tasks emerges.

There arises the need to protect people one has never met; to resolve disputes between strangers; to transmit knowledge far beyond one's own family; to preserve memory beyond the span of a human lifetime; to govern shared resources; to coordinate the actions of large numbers of people; to sustain exchange among strangers; to distribute responsibility among successive officeholders; and to make decisions whose consequences affect those who are absent or not yet born.

These tasks cannot be sustained solely by the means of the First Ontology—not because immediate human relationships are defective, nor because they must be replaced by some supposedly higher mode of existence. The reason lies simply in the limits of their scale.

The First Ontology answers the question of how one ought to relate to a concrete Other within the sphere of direct reciprocity. It does not, however, possess sufficient means for organizing stable responsibility toward countless strangers, absent persons, or future Others.

It is precisely this limitation that gives rise to the necessity of new social functions.

The Emergence of Social Functions

The limit of the First Ontology does not signify its collapse. Rather, it signifies the emergence of tasks for which immediate human relationships are no longer sufficient.

At this point, the social function emerges.

A social function is a relatively autonomous sphere of collective responsibility whose necessity is determined not by the existence of a particular individual but by the enduring needs of the community itself.

As long as responsibility remains confined to the sphere of direct reciprocity, function almost entirely coincides with relationship. Protection is provided by a relative; knowledge is transmitted by an elder; memory is preserved by living witnesses; disputes are settled by respected members of the community.

As society becomes increasingly complex, however, the function gradually separates itself from its concrete bearer and acquires a degree of autonomy.

The community discovers the need to sustain protection, judgment and reconciliation, governance, the transmission of knowledge, the preservation of memory, care, production, exchange, religious ministry, the public witness to truth, representation, mobilization, and the projection of the future as enduring social functions.

Each of these functions is initially born within the First Ontology, yet gradually extends beyond the sphere of direct reciprocity.

Protection ceases to mean merely the protection of one's own family.

Judgment ceases to be merely the reconciliation of acquaintances.

The transmission of knowledge ceases to be confined to the education of one's own children.

Memory ceases to be merely the memory of one's own lineage.

Responsibility begins to extend to those with whom the subject has no immediate personal relationship.

The social function thus becomes the first mechanism for the scaling of responsibility.

Its emergence therefore marks the transition to the Second Ontology.

The Second Ontology: The Ontology of Social Responsibility

The Second Ontology is the ontology of mediated—or social—responsibility.

It arises when immediate human relationships are no longer sufficient to sustain the growing complexity of social life, and responsibility comes to be exercised through functions, roles, and institutions.

The emergence of a social function does not yet imply the existence of a fully developed institution.

What first emerges is a new mode of relating to reality.

If the First Ontology organizes human existence around a concrete Other, the Second Ontology organizes it around the social function.

A person now acts not only as a son, father, brother, neighbor, or friend, but also as a judge, guardian of memory, protector of the community, teacher, ruler, mediator, or representative.

Responsibility is now determined not merely by one's direct relationship to a particular individual, but by one's relationship to a function whose meaning transcends the private ties of its bearer.

It is here that the distinctions indispensable to a complex society first arise:

the person and the office;

the personal and the public;

relationship and function;

sympathy and duty;

belonging and competence;

authority and legitimate powers;

intention and evidence;

private loyalty and public responsibility;

the concrete officeholder and the enduring function.

The historical significance of the Second Ontology lies in its expansion of responsibility beyond the sphere of direct reciprocity.

It makes possible action on behalf of strangers, absent persons, collective entities, and future generations.

Yet the Second Ontology no more produces subjecthood automatically than does the First.

A social function may become the space of genuinely responsible action, or it may be performed only externally.

An institution may sustain responsibility, or it may conceal its absence.

Procedure may restrain arbitrariness, or it may become a mechanism of impersonal irresponsibility.

An office may enlarge the scope of subjecthood, or it may relieve its holder of the necessity of giving a personal answer.

The Second Ontology therefore creates new possibilities for subjecthood without guaranteeing their realization.

The Differentiation of the Second Ontology

History does not stop with the emergence of social functions.

As societies grow, every function becomes increasingly complex, divides into specialized branches, and gives rise to new forms of activity.

This process is not a linear succession of one role replacing another.

It is a process of branching.

An originally unified function gradually divides into numerous specialized directions, each developing its own sphere of responsibility, its own language, its own standards of competence, its own methods of verification, and its own operational ontology.

The development of a social function should therefore be conceived not as a chain but as a tree.

The function of protection is initially concentrated in the figure of the clan protector. As society becomes more complex, it gives rise to the retainer, the warrior, the city guard, the border guard, and the military commander. These branches continue to differentiate, producing officers, military engineers, military physicians, intelligence officers, staff officers, logisticians, communications specialists, security analysts, and technological specialists. In contemporary society, the domain of protection encompasses not a single role but an entire family of interconnected operational ontologies, ranging from direct combat to strategic planning, cybersecurity, and the design of defense systems.

The function of transmitting knowledge develops in much the same way. The original relationship between elder and younger gives rise to mentorship, apprenticeship, literacy, and spiritual guidance. These branches later differentiate into school education, the university, scientific research, engineering, methodology, the design of educational systems, and the development of intellectual technologies.

The function of preserving memory first produces the storyteller and the guardian of tradition, then the chronicler, archivist, librarian, and annalist, and later the historian, archaeologist, museologist, source critic, digital archivist, and specialist in the preservation of information heritage.

The function of judgment and reconciliation develops from direct mediation into the stable judicial office, and subsequently branches into the judiciary, criminal investigation, prosecution, legal defense, arbitration, notarial practice, constitutional law, international law, mediation, and numerous other specialized forms.

The same pattern characterizes governance, care, medicine, economic life, construction, diplomacy, religious ministry, communication, the production of knowledge, and the organization of the economy.

Civilizational development, therefore, is not a sequential replacement of old roles by new ones.

It is the branching of social functions.

Each new branch preserves its connection to the original function while developing its own system of distinctions, its own sphere of responsibility, its own criteria of truth, and its own distinctive way of relating to reality.

The History of Society as the Differentiation of Social Functions

The history of society may therefore be described as the history of the differentiation of social functions, while the history of ontologies may be understood as the history of the branching of ways in which responsibility is organized.

The Emergence of Operational Ontologies

As social functions become increasingly differentiated, a stage is reached at which a single socio-institutional ontology is no longer sufficient.

Law, medicine, governance, military affairs, science, education, economics, and technological design each require distinct ways of relating to reality. Every field develops its own set of relevant facts, its own understanding of causality, its own temporal horizons, its own criteria of error and success, its own boundaries of competence, and its own forms of responsibility.

It is at this point that operational ontologies emerge.

An operational ontology is a local architecture of distinctions through which a particular social function is carried out within a specific sphere of activity.

It determines:

- what is regarded as real within that field;
- which elements of a situation are considered relevant;
- which causal relationships must be taken into account;
- how time is organized;
- who constitutes the Other;
- where the boundaries of competence lie;
- what counts as error;
- which consequences must be included within responsibility;
- which methods of verification and correction are considered legitimate;
- what constitutes a successful outcome.

A legal ontology distinguishes between norm, fact, evidence, authority, procedure, and responsibility.

A medical ontology distinguishes symptom, diagnosis, prognosis, intervention, risk, and the condition of the patient.

A scientific ontology distinguishes hypothesis, observation, experiment, argument, falsification, and reproducibility.

A military ontology distinguishes threat, resources, operational space, time, the intentions of the adversary, acceptable risk, and the cost of decision.

An economic ontology distinguishes value, exchange, scarcity, incentives, productivity, and distribution.

An administrative ontology distinguishes authority, regulations, governability, accountability, implementation, and oversight.

Each of these ontologies constitutes a specialized branch of the Second Ontology.

They arise neither directly from technology nor simply from institutional decisions.

Technology may create new possibilities for action, but an operational ontology emerges because a particular social function must be carried out under new conditions of complexity.

The genealogical sequence therefore assumes the following form:

new social task

→ emergence of a social function

→ formation of a role

- institutionalization
- differentiation of activity
- emergence of an operational ontology
- demand for a new quality of subjecthood

An operational ontology is local.

It neither describes the whole of reality nor should it aspire to do so.

Its purpose is to provide sufficient resolving power within a particular domain of action.

For this reason, a mature operational ontology must contain not only its own system of distinctions but also a clear awareness of the limits of their applicability.

Whenever those limits are forgotten, a local ontology begins to reduce everything else to its own perspective.

Law comes to see the human being merely as the bearer of legal status.

Economics sees only value.

Medicine sees only a clinical case.

Bureaucracy sees only an object of administration.

A digital system sees only data.

The differentiation of the Second Ontology therefore simultaneously expands the possibilities of social action and creates new risks of ontological reduction.

The Evolution of Ontologies

The evolution of ontologies is the historical process through which ways of organizing the human relationship to reality emerge, differentiate, become increasingly complex, and branch into new forms.

This evolution is not an automatic progression.

A new ontology is not necessarily truer, more humane, or more conducive to subjecthood than its predecessor.

Rather, it emerges because an earlier form reaches the limits of its own scale or resolving power and can no longer cope with a new class of tasks.

Every new ontology enlarges the scope of possible action.

At the same time, it enlarges the space of possible conflict.

New fractures emerge:

between immediate and social responsibility;

between personal relationship and public function;

between function and institution;

between the institution and the original meaning of its existence;

between different branches of the Second Ontology;

between specialized roles and the integrated personal architecture of the subject;

between the complexity of an operational ontology and the subject's capacity to sustain it.

The evolution of ontologies therefore does not automatically produce harmony.

It multiplies distinctions, expands the scale of action, and simultaneously places increasingly demanding requirements upon the subject.

Historically, this process may proceed far more rapidly than the formation of the corresponding subjecthood.

A society can import institutions, technologies, professional standards, or systems of governance within a relatively short period of time.

It cannot, however, acquire just as automatically subjects for whom the operational ontology embedded within those forms has become the substance of their own responsible action.

This mismatch constitutes one of the principal sources of modernization crises.

Conflicts Between Ontologies

The genealogical model makes it possible to understand social conflict not merely as a clash of interests, resources, identities, or norms, but as a conflict between different ways of organizing reality and responsibility.

A conflict of ontologies is a collision between systems of distinctions that define reality, the Other, causality, legitimate action, the limits of responsibility, and the criteria of truth in fundamentally different ways.

Such conflicts may arise between ontologies belonging to different genealogical levels, between separate branches of the Second Ontology, within a single operational ontology, or within the subject's own personal ontological architecture.

Conflict Between the First and Second Ontologies

This conflict arises whenever immediate responsibility toward a concrete Other collides with a social function.

Kinship requires helping one's own.

Justice requires treating friend and stranger alike.

Friendship demands personal loyalty.

Public office demands impartiality.

Family solidarity requires preserving resources within the group.

A social function requires distributing them according to universal criteria.

What confront each other here are not merely two behavioral norms.

They are two fundamentally different spaces of responsibility.

The First Ontology requires an answer before the concrete Other who belongs to the sphere of immediate reciprocity.

The Second Ontology requires an answer before the multitude, before procedure, before function, and before absent or collective Others.

Neither side can simply be declared false.

The conflict exists precisely because each preserves an authentic dimension of human existence.

The Collapse of the Second Ontology into the First

The Second Ontology collapses into the First whenever a public function becomes subordinated to the logic of immediate personal loyalty.

Public office becomes a family asset.

The court becomes an instrument of the clan.

The university becomes a system of patronage.

The state becomes an extension of private ownership.

The market becomes a mechanism for distributing benefits among one's own people.

The institutional form remains intact, yet its internal ontology is replaced by the ontology of immediate belonging.

This is not merely a violation of rules.

It is an ontological regression.

A function originally created to extend responsibility beyond the immediate circle is drawn back under the authority of that very circle.

The Absorption of the First Ontology by the Second

The opposite pathology arises when a social function and its operational ontology begin to claim the authority to define the human person exhaustively.

The individual is then reduced to nothing more than a worker, a patient, a soldier, a consumer, a taxpayer, a voter, an object of administration, or a unit of data.

The local reduction that is necessary for performing a particular function ceases to recognize its own locality and expands to encompass the subject's entire personal architecture.

The Second Ontology no longer serves the expansion of responsibility.

Instead, it replaces immediate human reality itself.

Conflict Between Different Branches of the Second Ontology

Specialized social functions may impose incompatible demands upon the same situation.

Law requires procedure.

Politics requires effectiveness.

Medicine gives priority to life and health.

Economics demands fiscal restraint.

Science requires openness to truth.

Bureaucracy demands governability and accountability.

Security requires control.

Civil liberty requires limits upon control.

Each of these ontologies may be internally coherent.

The conflict arises because each isolates a different aspect of the same reality and distributes responsibility according to different principles.

Intra-Operational Conflict

Conflict may also arise within a single sphere of activity.

A physician is simultaneously responsible before the individual patient, the standards of medical practice, the healthcare system, limited resources, and the long-term consequences of clinical decisions.

An officer bears responsibility before the mission, subordinates, civilians, military orders, the law, and the strategic outcome.

A scientist is responsible before truth, methodology, the institution, sources of funding, and the social consequences of research.

A single operational ontology may therefore contain multiple lines of responsibility that cannot be mechanically reduced to a single criterion.

Conflict Between Personal and Operational Ontologies

This conflict arises whenever a subject enters a sphere of activity whose internal logic cannot immediately be incorporated into the subject's already-formed personal architecture.

A new role may require the subject:

to distinguish between the personal and the public;

to abandon habitual patterns of causal explanation;

to assume responsibility for strangers;

to act within a much longer temporal horizon;

to acknowledge the limits of personal competence;

to subordinate immediate loyalty to universal criteria;

to endure the tension between multiple legitimate demands.

If the subject's personal architecture cannot sustain this degree of complexity, the new ontology will either be rejected, merely imitated, subordinated to the previous logic, or will result in the fragmentation of the subject's own existence.

The Reconciliation of Ontologies

The reconciliation of ontologies does not mean eliminating the distinctions between them.

Nor does it imply the automatic subordination of one ontology to another.

The First Ontology cannot replace social functions.

Familial care cannot replace medicine.

Friendship cannot replace justice.

Personal courage cannot replace an army.

Immediate trust cannot replace a system of public responsibility.

Conversely, the Second Ontology cannot define the human person exhaustively.

Legal status, professional role, administrative category, and economic function remain local determinations that never abolish the reality of the concrete Other.

The reconciliation of ontologies must therefore preserve their distinctions while simultaneously making their joint realization possible.

The reconciliation of ontologies is the subject's process of distinguishing, mutually testing, and integrating multiple ontologies into a unified configuration of action without reducing one ontology to another.

Such reconciliation involves:

preserving the internal distinctions of each ontology;

determining the sphere of its legitimate application;

identifying compatible and conflicting demands;

testing both ontologies against reality;

recognizing the limits of each;

the subject's own response;

assuming the corresponding responsibility;

restructuring the subject's personal architecture;

achieving a stable ontic embodiment of the resulting configuration.

Reconciliation does not necessarily culminate in synthesis.

Its outcome may instead be the limitation of one ontology's sphere of application, the separation of functions, the transformation of a role, institutional reform, the emergence of a new operational branch, or the conscious rejection of a particular ontology.

The decisive point is that conflict ceases to be resolved through the mechanical suppression of one ontology by another or through the concealed domination of one over the other.

Instead, it becomes the object of subjective transformation.

For this reason, reconciliation cannot be accomplished by structures themselves.

It requires a subject capable of sustaining several ontologies simultaneously, distinguishing their respective grounds, limits, and demands, and accepting personal responsibility for the resulting configuration.

From the Evolution of Ontologies to the Subjective Transition

The genealogy of ontologies describes the historical dimension of the process.

It explains how new social tasks, functions, roles, institutions, and operational ontologies come into existence.

Yet the emergence of a new ontology does not in itself constitute its historical realization.

An ontology may be formulated, institutionalized, embodied in law, technology, or professional standards, and still remain external to the subjects who are expected to enact it.

The evolution of ontologies must therefore be distinguished from the ontogenesis of subjecthood.

The former is the historical emergence and increasing complexity of forms of social action.

The latter is the personal development of the capacity to distinguish, interiorize, reconcile, and responsibly enact those forms.

The evolution of ontologies is historical.

The ontogenesis of subjecthood is personal.

Their encounter takes place in the subjective transition.

It is precisely at this point that the genealogy of ontologies converges with the architecture developed in CTM II.

The present study does not seek to reconstruct the ontogenesis of subjecthood, since this has already been examined in detail in CTM II.

For the purposes of modernization theory, a different point is decisive:

Every new operational ontology can be genuinely accepted only through the subjective transition whose architecture has already been described.

A new ontology must not merely be learned.

It must be recognized, related to reality, tested, incorporated into the hermeneutics of responsibility, freely accepted or rejected, integrated into the subject's personal architecture, and crystallized in the subject's own action.

Modernization therefore begins neither with institutions nor with technology.

It begins at the moment when a historically emergent ontology becomes the object of the subject's own response.

The Subjective Transition as the Condition of Modernization

A new operational ontology does not enter the subject's personal architecture automatically.

The mere existence of an institution, a role, a norm, or a professional standard does not mean that its internal logic has become part of the person's own action.

It is precisely here that the boundary lies between external adaptation and subjective modernization.

External adaptation may be achieved through education, discipline, supervision, repetition, and sanctions.

It can produce correct behavior, procedural stability, and reproducible outcomes.

The subjective transition, however, begins only when the new ontology ceases to be an external requirement and becomes the object of the subject's own response.

The Subjective Transition

The subjective transition is the transformation of the subject's personal ontological architecture through which a new ontology is recognized, tested, accepted into responsibility, and becomes capable of unfolding in the subject's own action.

Such a transition cannot be reduced to the acquisition of new knowledge.

It transforms the very manner in which the subject relates to reality.
 A new operational ontology may require the subject:
 to expand the scope of reality taken into account;
 to distinguish levels that had previously remained undifferentiated;
 to revise habitual patterns of causal explanation;
 to extend the temporal horizon of action;
 to include strangers, absent persons, or future Others within the sphere of responsibility;
 to recognize the limits of personal competence;
 to abandon the automaticity of previous responses;
 to sustain the tension between multiple legitimate demands;
 to reconstruct the subject's own scenario book;
 to accept a new cost of error.

For this reason, every subjective transition necessarily contains a moment of crisis within the previous architecture.

If the existing configuration is already fully adequate for the new activity, no genuine transition occurs.

The subject merely applies already existing distinctions to new material.

The transition begins precisely where the new ontology reveals the limits of the previous mode of existence.

In this sense, the structure of personal development mirrors the general logic of the genealogy of ontologies.

Historically, a new ontology emerges as a response to the limits of an earlier form of social action.

Personally, the subjective transition begins with the discovery of the limits of one's own ontological architecture.

The same structure therefore operates on two different levels:

limit of the previous form

→ emergence of a new task

→ necessity of a new distinction

→ transformation of the architecture

→ expansion of the space of responsibility

The historical and personal trajectories, however, do not coincide.

History may generate a new function—and even institutionalize it—before subjects capable of sustaining it have emerged.

A new ontology may therefore exist externally without ever becoming subjectively realized.

The Architecture of CTM II as a Model of the Subjective Transition

CTM II describes the ontogenesis of subjecthood as a sequence of transformations through which the human being becomes capable not merely of reproducing pre-existing causality but of giving a personal response to reality.

Within modernization theory, this architecture acquires a recursive significance.

It describes not only the original emergence of subjecthood but also the structure of every subsequent subjective transition.

Whenever a person enters a new operational ontology, the existing architecture is tested for its adequacy.

The new ontology must pass through the same fundamental operations without which no genuine personal response is possible.

This does not imply a literal repetition of the entire ontogenesis.

A mature subject does not return to the starting point.

Nevertheless, every new transition reactivates the fundamental elements of the already established architecture.

The new ontology must first be accepted as reality, rather than merely as a system of external symbols.

Its origin and the social function from which it emerged must be recognized.

The responsibility it imposes upon the subject must be identified.

It must be tested against reality itself rather than merely against institutional authority.

Its local foundations must be distinguished from ultimate ones.

The subject must determine a personal response—acceptance, transformation, limitation, or rejection.

The outcome must receive ontic expression in action.

If the existing configuration proves insufficient, re-foundation becomes necessary.

CTM II therefore functions within modernization theory not as material to be repeated but as an already developed model of the transformation of the subject.

The genealogy of ontologies describes the historical emergence of new complexity.

CTM II describes the architecture of the subject's response to that complexity.

Modernization occurs only at the point where these two processes genuinely converge.

Subjective Capacity

For a subject to sustain a new operational ontology, the subject's personal architecture must possess a corresponding capacity.

Subjective capacity is the ability of a personal ontological architecture to sustain multiple ontologies, roles, temporal horizons, and lines of responsibility without losing coherence, identity, or the capacity to give one's own response.

Subjective capacity is not identical with the amount of knowledge one possesses.

A person may command extensive learning, master sophisticated technologies, and perform highly specialized operations while remaining incapable of integrating them into a unified architecture of responsibility.

Nor is subjective capacity identical with the number of roles one performs.

A multiplicity of roles may indicate not complexity but fragmentation.

Subjective capacity comprises at least five interrelated dimensions.

Scale determines the extent of reality and responsibility that the subject can sustain.

Resolving power determines the precision with which the subject distinguishes objects, levels, causal relationships, and limits of applicability.

Coherence enables multiple ontologies to be integrated into a unified architecture without confusing them or reducing personal existence to disconnected modes of operation.

Multi-threadedness makes it possible to sustain multiple simultaneous lines of action, temporal horizons, and responsibilities.

Correctability provides the capacity to recognize the inadequacy of one's own configuration and to reconstruct it.

A new ontology may exceed the subject's capacity in any one of these dimensions.

A subject may understand individual operations while remaining incapable of sustaining the scale of the function.

One may perceive the general objective while failing to distinguish essential details.

One may function successfully within a particular role while being unable to relate it to other areas of one's own existence.

One may sustain a single line of responsibility while becoming disoriented when confronted with several simultaneously.

One may faithfully reproduce a successful pattern of action while proving incapable of correcting it when circumstances change.

From this follows a general principle:

A society cannot sustain a level of complexity over the long term if it lacks subjects possessing the corresponding scale and resolving power.

A society may import institutions, technologies, professional standards, and even the languages through which it describes itself.

It may construct organizations of considerable external complexity.

Yet if the quality of its subjects' personal architectures remains below the level required by the functions they are expected to perform, society inevitably becomes dependent upon instructions, permanent supervision, and externally imposed projectuality.

Logosness

Even subjective capacity alone is insufficient.

A subject may sustain a highly complex ontology, operate within it effectively, and even contribute to its development while failing to preserve a genuine relationship between ontology, reality, and personal response.

An institution may reproduce sophisticated procedures while losing contact with the social function from which it originally emerged.

A professional system may remain internally coherent while reducing reality to those parameters that are convenient for itself.

A subject may freely embrace a false or closed ontology and responsibly enact distinctions that are themselves fundamentally unsound.

Consequently, the quality of modernization cannot be determined solely by the complexity of an ontology, the autonomy of the subject, or the stability of an institution.

A further concept is required—one capable of describing the quality of their actual relationship.

Logosness is the integral quality of the relationship between ontology, subject, and reality, whereby the distinctions of an ontology are recognized by the subject, verified against reality, and become the content of the subject's own responsible action.

Logosness does not belong exclusively to ontology.

An internally coherent system may be reproduced without understanding and without personal response.

Nor does it belong exclusively to the subject.

A free and responsible response may nevertheless remain fundamentally inadequate in relation to reality.

Logosness characterizes the realized relationship between three poles:

ontology as a system of distinctions;

the subject as the source of a personal response;

reality as the ultimate criterion of verification and correction.

It presupposes:

semantic coherence;

ontological verifiability;

openness to truth;

the distinction between the local and the ultimate;

an understanding of the limits of applicability;

the preservation of the reality of the Other;

responsibility for consequences;

the possibility of refutation and correction.

In this sense, the genealogy of ontologies answers the question of what has historically emerged.

The architecture of subjecthood answers the question of who is capable of sustaining it.

Logosness answers the question of how truthfully their encounter has actually taken place.

For this reason, logosness is not an additional virtue of modernization but the criterion of its quality.

Institutions can be imported.

Procedures can be reproduced.

Technologies can be transferred.

Professional roles can be taught.

But logosness cannot be imported in finished form.

It arises only through the actual relationship between the subject, ontology, and reality.

This is why institutions that appear externally identical may possess fundamentally different qualities in different societies.

Interiorization

In its conventional usage, interiorization is often understood as the transformation of external norms, rules, or behavioral models into an individual's internal dispositions.

For the purposes of the present study, such an understanding is insufficient.

Interiorization is the subject's incorporation of the recognized and ontologically verified content of an operational ontology into the subject's personal ontological architecture.

Interiorization is not copying.

The subject does not simply absorb a ready-made ontology unchanged.

The new ontology enters an already existing architecture, where it encounters other distinctions, forms of responsibility, experiences, and the subject's own identity.

Interiorization therefore necessarily involves mutual transformation.

The personal architecture expands or is reconfigured.

The operational ontology acquires a concrete subjective realization, often refining its own boundaries and distinctions in the process.

At its minimum, interiorization includes:

recognizing the internal structure of the activity;

reconstructing its original social function;

distinguishing ends, means, and derivative forms;

testing it against reality;

determining the limits of its applicability;

relating it to ontologies already sustained by the subject;

identifying conflicts;

giving one's own response;

accepting responsibility;

restructuring the personal architecture;

acquiring the capacity to reproduce, correct, and further develop the activity independently.

Interiorization does not occur when the subject has merely learned to act correctly.

It occurs when the subject becomes capable of assuming responsibility for the internal logic of the action and of continuing it when the predetermined scenario ceases to be sufficient.

Another person may transmit knowledge.

Demonstrate an example.

Establish an institution.

Formulate a rule.

Enforce compliance.

But no one can give the subject's own response in the subject's place.

For this reason, interiorization cannot be derivative.

Interiorization and External Influence

Education, socialization, discipline, and institutional coercion should not be regarded as useless or false.

They are capable of creating the necessary conditions for the subjective transition.

They transmit language.

They cultivate skills.

They establish habits of precision.

They restrain arbitrariness.

They ensure reproducibility.

They enable a person to enter a sphere of activity before fully understanding its foundations.

None of these processes, however, is identical with interiorization.

They may produce a highly competent performer without giving rise to the subject of the activity.

The decisive distinction does not lie between the external and the internal in a merely psychological sense.

A person may deeply internalize a norm, sincerely identify with an institution, and faithfully reproduce its requirements while nevertheless remaining a bearer of external causality.

The true distinction lies between derivative action and one's own response.

The performer merely continues a chain of causality whose source remains outside the performer's own architecture.

The subject assumes that causality into personal responsibility, tests it, and becomes capable of acting where external instruction is no longer sufficient.

For this reason, CTM's theory of modernization is not concerned with the means by which human beings are ultimately adapted to a new social order.

Its concern is the emergence of a subject capable of independently sustaining, testing, and developing the corresponding ontology.

The Scenario Book of Subjective Action

The interiorization of a new ontology is not completed simply by accepting it.

As long as the new ontology remains merely a collection of isolated items of knowledge, rules, or professional requirements, it has not yet become a stable part of the subject's personal ontological architecture.

It becomes stable only when it begins to unfold autonomously in action.

This becomes possible through the formation of the scenario book of subjective action.

A scenario book is the subject's internal system of acquired modes of distinction, understanding, and action through which recurring classes of situations are recognized, their ontological structure is identified, and an appropriate response is independently constructed.

A scenario book is neither a collection of instructions nor an algorithm of behavior.

Rather, it consists of typical structures of subjective response that integrate perception of the situation, discrimination of what is essential, understanding of causal relations, anticipation of consequences, choice of action, and the assumption of responsibility.

Every operational ontology requires the formation of its own scenario book.

As the subject masters the corresponding sphere of activity, this scenario book gradually becomes incorporated into the subject's own ontological architecture.

Medical ontology forms the physician's scenario book.

Legal ontology forms the judge's scenario book.

Military ontology forms the officer's scenario book.

Scientific ontology forms the researcher's scenario book.

Educational ontology forms the teacher's scenario book.

Professional formation is therefore not merely the accumulation of experience or the mechanical mastery of procedures.

It is the gradual expansion, refinement, and increasing complexity of the scenario book through which the subject becomes capable of independently carrying out the corresponding social function.

Yet the scenario book alone still does not guarantee subjecthood.

A person may possess an extraordinarily rich scenario book while remaining nothing more than a highly qualified performer.

One may flawlessly recognize situations and consistently choose the most effective course of action while never giving one's own response.

The scenario book is therefore a necessary condition for subjective action, but not a sufficient one.

A further question therefore arises:

How does the subject become capable not only of expanding the scenario book, but also of sustaining the ever-increasing complexity of multiple ontologies without losing the center of personal responsibility?

It is precisely this question that leads the investigation to the problem of the cost of the subjective transition and to the concept of subjective capacity.

The Cost of the Subjective Transition

Neither the First Ontology, the Second Ontology, nor any operational ontology by itself produces subjecthood.

Immediate relationships may become oppressive.

Institutions may conceal the absence of responsibility.

Professional complexity may produce a perfect performer.

Even an ontology possessing logosness does not eliminate the necessity of a personal response.

Every transition to a more complex ontological configuration has its cost.

The subject pays through the abandonment of the automaticity of previous responses.

By acknowledging one's own insufficiency and incompetence.

By making the effort to understand an unfamiliar logic.

By accepting the risk of error.

By revising one's accustomed identity.

By expanding the scope of responsibility.

By becoming willing to sustain conflicts between legitimate demands.

By relinquishing certain former privileges.

By accepting the possibility of conflict with one's own social environment.

By undergoing re-foundation.

This capacity may be described as ontological solvency.

Ontological solvency is the capacity of the subject to accept the real cost of one's own response without transferring that cost onto the Other, an institution, a fiction, or external coercion.

Without such payment, a new ontology may be mastered technically, yet never become part of the subject's own mode of existence.

In that case, imitation emerges.

The subject acquires the external results of greater complexity without paying for them through the transformation of one's own ontological architecture.

Modernization as the Meeting of Two Processes

At this point, the two fundamental processes can finally be distinguished.

The evolution of ontologies consists in the historical emergence of new social tasks, functions, roles, institutions, and operational ontologies, together with their subsequent branching and increasing complexity.

The ontogenesis of subjecthood consists in the personal development of the capacity to accept reality, distinguish ontologies, sustain their complexity, test them,

give one's own response, assume responsibility, and crystallize that response in action.

These processes are related but not identical.

The evolution of ontologies may proceed without a corresponding ontogenesis of subjecthood.

An institution may be created long before subjects capable of embodying its internal logic come into existence.

The reverse situation is likewise possible.

A subject may possess greater complexity, projectuality, and responsibility than the surrounding social environment can accommodate, while lacking any opportunity for their ontic realization.

Modernization arises only where these two trajectories enter into a productive relationship.

Modernization is the subjective process through which the historical evolution of social and operational ontologies is brought into correspondence with the ontogenesis of subjecthood.

It cannot be reduced to the creation of new institutions.

It is not exhausted by training people for new roles.

It does not coincide with changes in behavior.

Nor is it guaranteed by increasing complexity alone.

Modernization takes place when a historically emerged ontology becomes the object of the subject's own response, passes through verification, is interiorized, accepted into responsibility, and acquires a stable ontic expression.

Modernization is therefore a particular case of the subjective transition.

At the personal level, it signifies the transformation of the human ontological architecture.

At the social level, it signifies the emergence of a sufficient number of subjects capable of sustaining a new social function without continual external coercion.

At the historical level, it signifies the crystallization of a new form of social action.

For this reason, the evolution of ontologies is historical, the ontogenesis of subjecthood is personal, and modernization is social.

The Logic of Modernization Failures

If modernization is understood as the correspondence between the historical evolution of ontologies and the ontogenesis of subjecthood, the reasons for the repeated failures of modernization projects become considerably clearer.

Most classical theories of modernization assumed that it would be sufficient to establish new institutions, introduce modern technologies, reform legislation, transform education, or reorganize systems of governance.

The corresponding type of human being was expected to emerge automatically from these altered social conditions.

The present model suggests a different picture.

The historical evolution of ontologies can indeed be accelerated.

A society may rapidly import institutions, professional standards, universities, digital technologies, financial systems, models of public administration, and even entire forms of social organization.

The ontogenesis of subjecthood, however, follows a fundamentally different logic.

It cannot be imported.
It cannot be copied.
It cannot be imposed.
It cannot be produced by administrative decision.
It requires the subject's own response.

This explains why modernization projects so often produce external complexity without corresponding internal substance.

Modern institutions appear without institutional consciousness.

Law without legal consciousness.

Education without thinking.

Science without the pursuit of truth.

Professional activity without responsibility.

Technological complexity without subjective competence.

Under such conditions a modernization gap emerges.

The historical evolution of ontologies begins to outpace the ontogenesis of subjecthood.

Imitative Modernization

When this gap becomes permanent, a distinctive form of social development emerges that may be described as imitative modernization.

Outwardly, such a society displays all the signs of advanced complexity.

It possesses universities, courts, parliaments, modern armed forces, a digital economy, research centers, an extensive bureaucracy, and systems of professional education.

Yet the internal logic of these institutions has not been interiorized.

Operational ontologies continue to exist merely as external scenarios of activity.

They are reproduced procedurally but are not sustained subjectively.

As a result, complex institutional forms gradually become filled with the content of much earlier ontologies.

The court becomes an extension of kinship.

Public office becomes an extension of personal dependence.

Economic activity becomes another form of patronage.

Professional competence becomes a consequence of group affiliation.

A formally modern institution begins to function according to the logic of the First Ontology.

This is why such societies may appear externally modernized while remaining internally ontologically heterogeneous.

Criterion of the Quality of Modernization

The proposed model makes it possible to formulate a different criterion for evaluating modernization processes.

The quality of modernization is not determined by the number of reforms.

Nor by the volume of investment.

Nor by the rate of economic growth.

Nor by the level of technological development.

Not even by the complexity of institutional arrangements.

All of these parameters primarily characterize the historical evolution of ontologies.

They say nothing, however, about the quality of their subjective realization.

From this perspective, the principal criterion of modernization is a society's capacity to reproduce subjects capable of sustaining the increasing complexity of social action.

Modernization is therefore, above all, an anthropological problem.

History generates increasingly complex social functions.

Only the subject can make them real.

The Generative Potential of CTM

The results of the present study extend far beyond the theory of modernization itself.

The investigation has demonstrated that the conceptual framework of CTM is capable not merely of analyzing already familiar phenomena but also of discovering entirely new fields of inquiry.

The original question concerned modernization.

Yet its consistent development led inevitably to the reconstruction of the genealogy of ontologies.

The genealogy of ontologies, in turn, required recourse to the ontogenesis of subjecthood developed in CTM II.

A new research configuration thus emerged, within which each newly discovered problem naturally gives rise to the next.

It is precisely this capacity for the continuous expansion of the field of inquiry that makes it possible to regard CTM not as a completed philosophical system but as a generative research platform.

Conclusion

The present investigation makes it possible to formulate several principal conclusions.

First, modernization is not an independent historical process but a particular case of the far more comprehensive genealogy of ontologies.

Second, the historical evolution of social functions, institutions, and operational ontologies is fundamentally distinct from the ontogenesis of subjecthood, although the two processes continually interact.

Third, the subjective transition is the indispensable condition of every genuine modernization.

Neither institutions, nor education, nor technology, nor discipline can by themselves produce the subject.

Fourth, the quality of modernization is determined not by the complexity of institutions as such, but by the capacity of society to reproduce subjects capable of sustaining the corresponding degree of complexity.

Finally, the present analysis has demonstrated that the conceptual framework developed in CTM possesses an independent generative capacity.

The consistent investigation of a single problem naturally leads to the discovery of new objects of inquiry, new disciplines, and new research programs.

The theory of modernization has become the first practical application of CTM.

The genealogy of ontologies has identified the subject matter of the future General Theory of Ontological Architectures (GTOA).

CTM II has already provided the architecture of the ontogenesis of subjecthood.

A unified field of inquiry therefore emerges, within which the philosophy of subjecthood, the genealogy of ontologies, and the theory of modernization

constitute different levels of description of one and the same process—the historical emergence of the human subject within an increasingly complex world.

еальность, Основание и Логос
280 удержание предельного горизонта
281 фикция
282 Фильтр 10^{-17}
283 энтропия
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LIST OF KEY TERMS OF THE CTM PROJECT

I. REALITY, BEING, AND ONTOLOGY

1. Absolute
2. variability of metaphysics
3. external ground
4. horizon
5. horizon of being
6. dynamic iconic space (DIS)
7. gap between the accessible and the real
8. interiorized reality
9. quality of ontology
10. quality of claim
11. collective ontology
12. competitive ontology
13. Logos-shaped reality
14. metaphysical closure
15. metaphysical presupposition
16. metaphysical horizon
17. multiplicity
18. ontics
19. ontic horizon
20. ontic meaning
21. ontological capacity
22. ontological horizon
23. ontological scale
24. ontological profile
25. ontological realism
26. ontological status
27. ontology as dynamic iconic space
28. ontology as an operating system
29. ontology as subjecthood
30. ontology of the subject
31. ontology of fiction
32. personal ontological architecture of the subject
33. participatory ontology
34. space of possible metaphysical models
35. space of human experience
36. dimensionality of the ontological horizon
37. dimensionality, multilevelness, and multithreading
38. resolution and coherence (structural integration)
39. reality
40. reality as horizon
41. meaning
42. semantic determinacy of reality
43. solidaristic ontology

- 44. structural maturity, vitality, and subjecthood
- 45. substantial-nominative metaphysics
- 46. form of being
- 47. humanness

II. SUBJECT, PERSON, AND SUBJECTHOOD

- 48. genesis of subjecthood
- 49. historical subjecthood
- 50. collective subject
- 51. person
- 52. scale of the subject
- 53. scale of subjecthood
- 54. messianic identity
- 55. messianic subjecthood
- 56. minimal position of subjecthood
- 57. continuity (law of the subject)
- 58. ontic subjecthood
- 59. ontogenesis of subjecthood
- 60. ontoprojectual subjecthood
- 61. personal subjecthood
- 62. fullness of humanness
- 63. space of subjecthood
- 64. space of subjectual responsibility
- 65. one's own voice
- 66. subject
- 67. subject capable of sustaining the corresponding complexity
- 68. subjectivity
- 69. subjectual capacity
- 70. position of subjecthood
- 71. subjecthood
- 72. self-identity
- 73. identity through participation
- 74. the human

III. FREEDOM, RESPONSIBILITY, AND THE FORMATION OF THE SUBJECT

- 75. taste for freedom
- 76. hermeneutics of determinism
- 77. hermeneutics of beginning
- 78. hermeneutics of resentment
- 79. hermeneutics of responsibility
- 80. hermeneutics of negation
- 81. hermeneutics of privilege
- 82. derivative existence
- 83. derivative mode
- 84. derivativeness

- 85. inertial position
- 86. crisis of autonomy
- 87. crisis of autonomous totality
- 88. non-derivativeness
- 89. domain of responsibility
- 90. ontological autonomy
- 91. ontological mobilization
- 92. ontological solvency
- 93. ontological claim
- 94. ontological freedom
- 95. response to the gift of existence
- 96. responsibility
- 97. attempt and failure of autonomy
- 98. limit
- 99. limit of self-foundation
- 100. acceptance of oneself
- 101. acceptance of one's own beginning
- 102. acceptance of one's own expansiveness
- 103. productive hermeneutics
- 104. freedom
- 105. subjectual hermeneutics
- 106. subjectual mobilization
- 107. subjectual energy
- 108. subjecthood as continuous mobilization
- 109. subjectual transition
- 110. price of the subjectual transition
- 111. language of responsibility

IV. THE OTHER, COMMUNICATION, AND SOCIALITY

- 112. act of the social
- 113. Other
- 114. closed relationality
- 115. communication
- 116. competitive and solidaristic ontology
- 117. initial ontological empathy
- 118. ontic communication
- 119. ontological distance
- 120. ontological communication
- 121. grounded relationality
- 122. relationality
- 123. social action
- 124. participation

V. ACTION, PROJECTUALITY, FUTURE, AND HISTORY

- 125. action

- 126. generativity
- 127. generative potential of CTM
- 128. infrastructure for modeling the future
- 129. historical projectuality
- 130. living time
- 131. metaprojectual function
- 132. metaphysical toolkit
- 133. model of the future
- 134. dead time
- 135. ontic action
- 136. ontological act
- 137. ontological action
- 138. ontology of the act
- 139. limit of history
- 140. limit of mass mobilization
- 141. being-sent
- 142. project of the future
- 143. projectuality
- 144. space of human action
- 145. psychological action
- 146. mode of dead time
- 147. decision
- 148. scenario book
- 149. scenario book of subjectual action
- 150. one's own and another's projectuality
- 151. one's own practice of modeling
- 152. one's own project of the future
- 153. one's own projectual toolkit
- 154. socio-ontic projectuality
- 155. socio-ontic embodiment
- 156. socio-eschatological projectuality
- 157. structure of the act
- 158. subjectual projectuality
- 159. formation of the toolkit for one's own project of the future
- 160. formation of a historical project
- 161. formation of an image of the future
- 162. goal-setting
- 163. price of action
- 164. entropy of action

VI. SOCIAL COMPLEXITY, ONTOLOGIES, AND MODERNIZATION

- 165. increasing complexity
- 166. genealogy of ontologies
- 167. decolonization of the person
- 168. imitative modernization
- 169. interiorization

- 170. interiorization and sustaining contradiction
- 171. colonization
- 172. conflict of ontologies
- 173. criterion of the quality of modernization
- 174. modernization crisis
- 175. modernization gap
- 176. modernization
- 177. operational ontology
- 178. limit of complexity
- 179. coordination of ontologies
- 180. subjectual interiorization
- 181. civilizational development
- 182. evolution of ontologies

VII. GROUND, LOGOS, AND FAITH

- 183. faith as competence
- 184. faith as sustaining orientation
- 185. gravity of ontics
- 186. Logos
- 187. Logos of logoi
- 188. Logos-fleeing ontology
- 189. logosness
- 190. Logos-shaped action
- 191. Logos-centric ontology
- 192. logocentrism
- 193. methodological monotheism
- 194. ontological redirection
- 195. ontological ground
- 196. ground
- 197. Ground of grounds
- 198. re-foundation
- 199. transcendent openness
- 200. foundation
- 201. groundedness

VIII. CHURCH AND ESCHATOLOGY

- 202. Christ bin
- 203. tikkun olam
- 204. act of the Church
- 205. act/event of the Church
- 206. actualization of the Church
- 207. apocalyptic paralysis
- 208. imitation of the Church
- 209. liturgy as an ontological process
- 210. messianic narcissism

- 211. ontological memory
- 212. pathology of eschatological and historical projectuality
- 213. personal eschatology
- 214. practice of the Cross
- 215. social eschatology
- 216. utopianism
- 217. Church
- 218. Aeon
- 219. eschatological inflation
- 220. eschatological verification
- 221. eschatological subjecthood
- 222. Eschaton

IX. METHOD, DIAGNOSIS, TRANSFORMATION, AND PATHOLOGIES

- 223. verification of metaphysics
- 224. verifiability
- 225. vitality of ontology
- 226. degradation
- 227. closed immanence
- 228. imitation
- 229. competence
- 230. competency
- 231. competence of being
- 232. criterion of distinction
- 233. crystallization
- 234. crystallization of a new ontology
- 235. false meaning and simulation
- 236. meta-navigation
- 237. metacompetence
- 238. metaphysics of post-metaphysics
- 239. navigation
- 240. ontologization of ontics
- 241. ontological asceticism
- 242. ontological verifiability
- 243. ontological competence
- 244. ontological navigation
- 245. ontological falsifiability
- 246. ontological halt
- 247. ontological position
- 248. ontological presupposition
- 249. ontological reduction
- 250. ontological reflexivity
- 251. ontological seriousness
- 252. ontological therapy
- 253. ontological transformation
- 254. ontological function

- 255. ontological etherification
- 256. ontological vacuum
- 257. ontological explosion
- 258. ontological dissonance
- 259. ontological conformist
- 260. ontological breakthrough
- 261. ontological recipient
- 262. ontological transmitter
- 263. ontological tension
- 264. transfer of competence
- 265. precedence of reality
- 266. presumption of the semantic determinacy of reality
- 267. recognition of reality
- 268. applied metaphysics
- 269. applied metaphysics of the subject
- 270. principle of ontological falsifiability
- 271. distinction of registers
- 272. receptivity
- 273. reductionism
- 274. reduction of reality
- 275. self-deification
- 276. self-determination
- 277. self-correction
- 278. simulation
- 279. subjecthood as response: reality, Ground, and Logos
- 280. sustaining the ultimate horizon
- 281. fiction
- 282. 10^{-17} Filter
- 283. entropy
- 284. Τί τὸ ὄν ἐν ἐμοί;

After-Silence

On the surface, the logic of the text seems to call for an afterword. There will be none. Instead, there will be an after-silence— an ecclesiological after-silence.

It is no accident that this volume is called a project. From this point onward, let the Body of Christ speak.